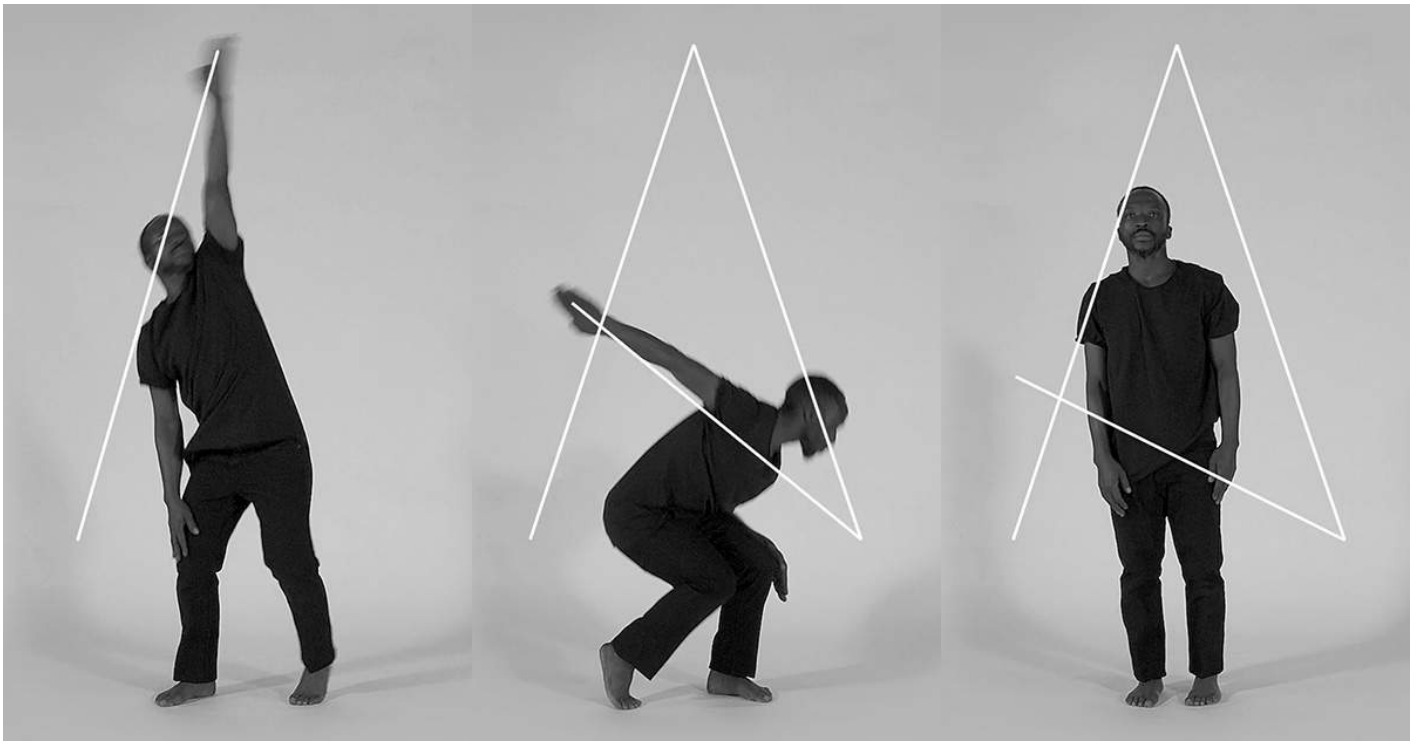


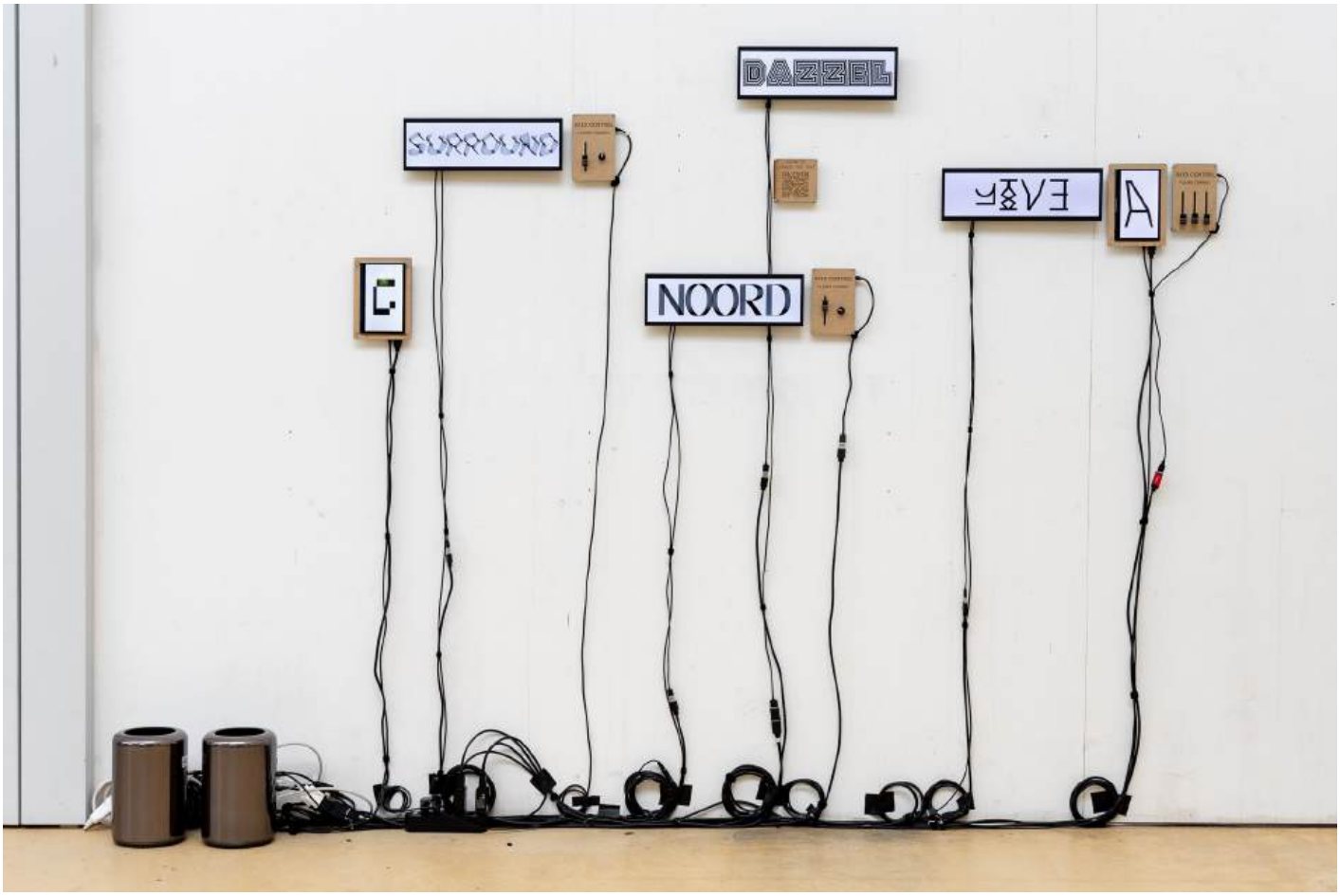
Movement
NM Type
Variable typeface exploring motion and rhythm.
↳ eyeondesign.aiga.org/typography-dancing-like-its-never…
↳ nmtype.com/movement



Nike Olympics
Pizza Typefaces
Custom type system inspired by athletic movement.
↳ itsnicethat.com/articles/pizza-typefaces-nike-olympics…

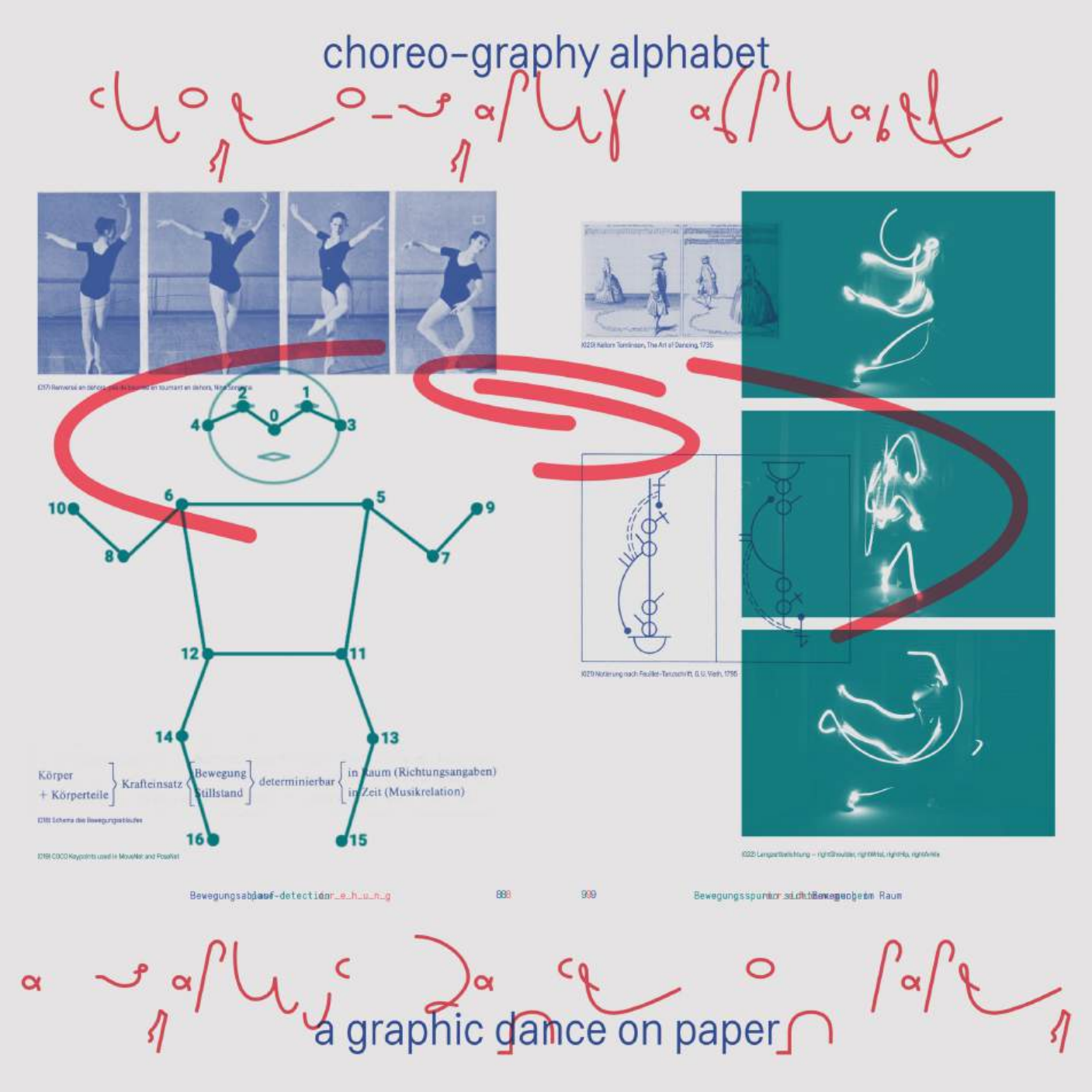


Schrift-Körper
Alain Aebersold, Biel
A typeface that allows for dynamic visual communication.
↳ alainaebersold.ch/schrift-korper


DAZZEL
NOORD



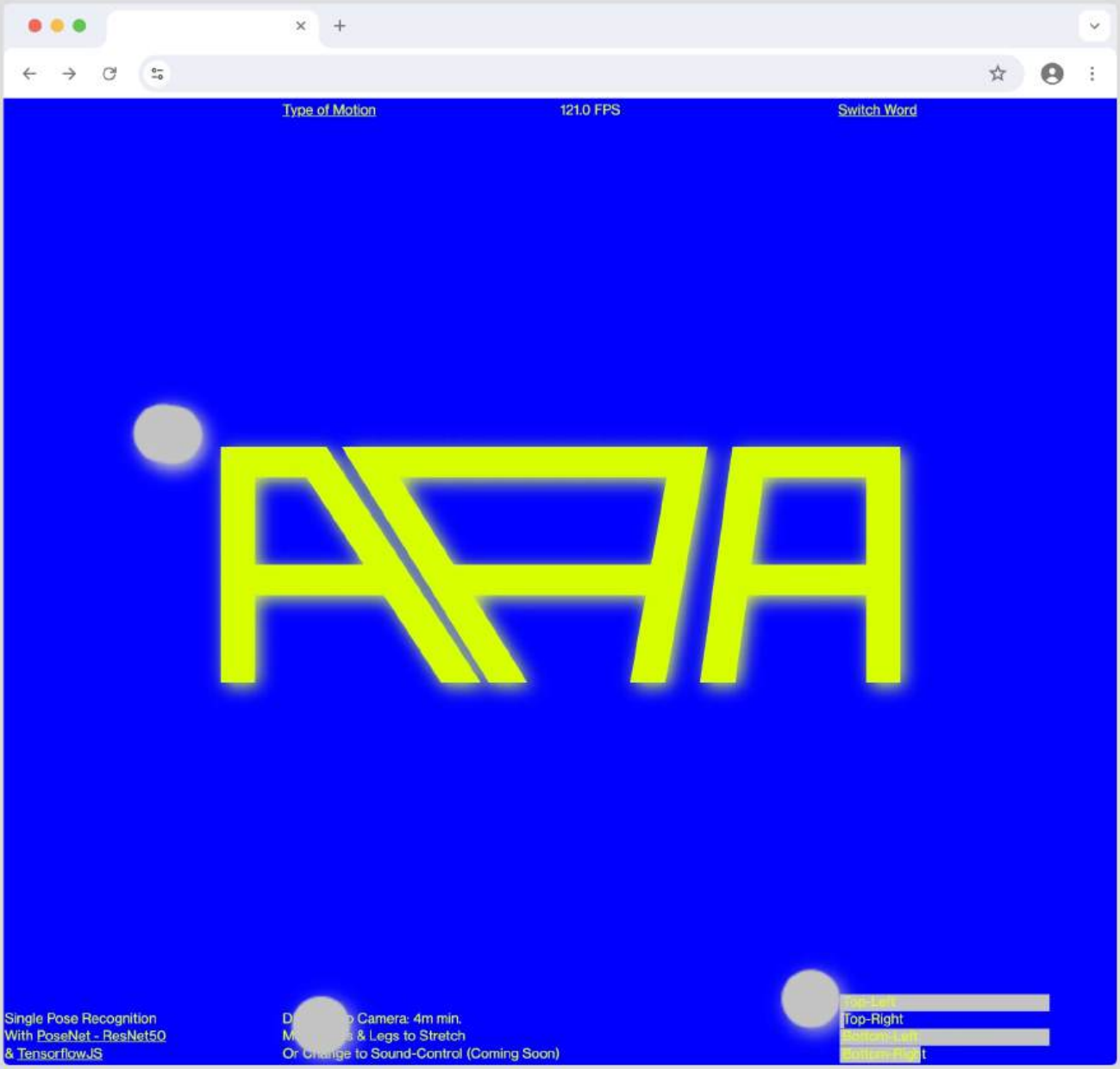
_Anatomie der Buchstaben
Karen Cheng (2006; 2nd ed. 2020)
Basiswissen für Schriftgestalter.



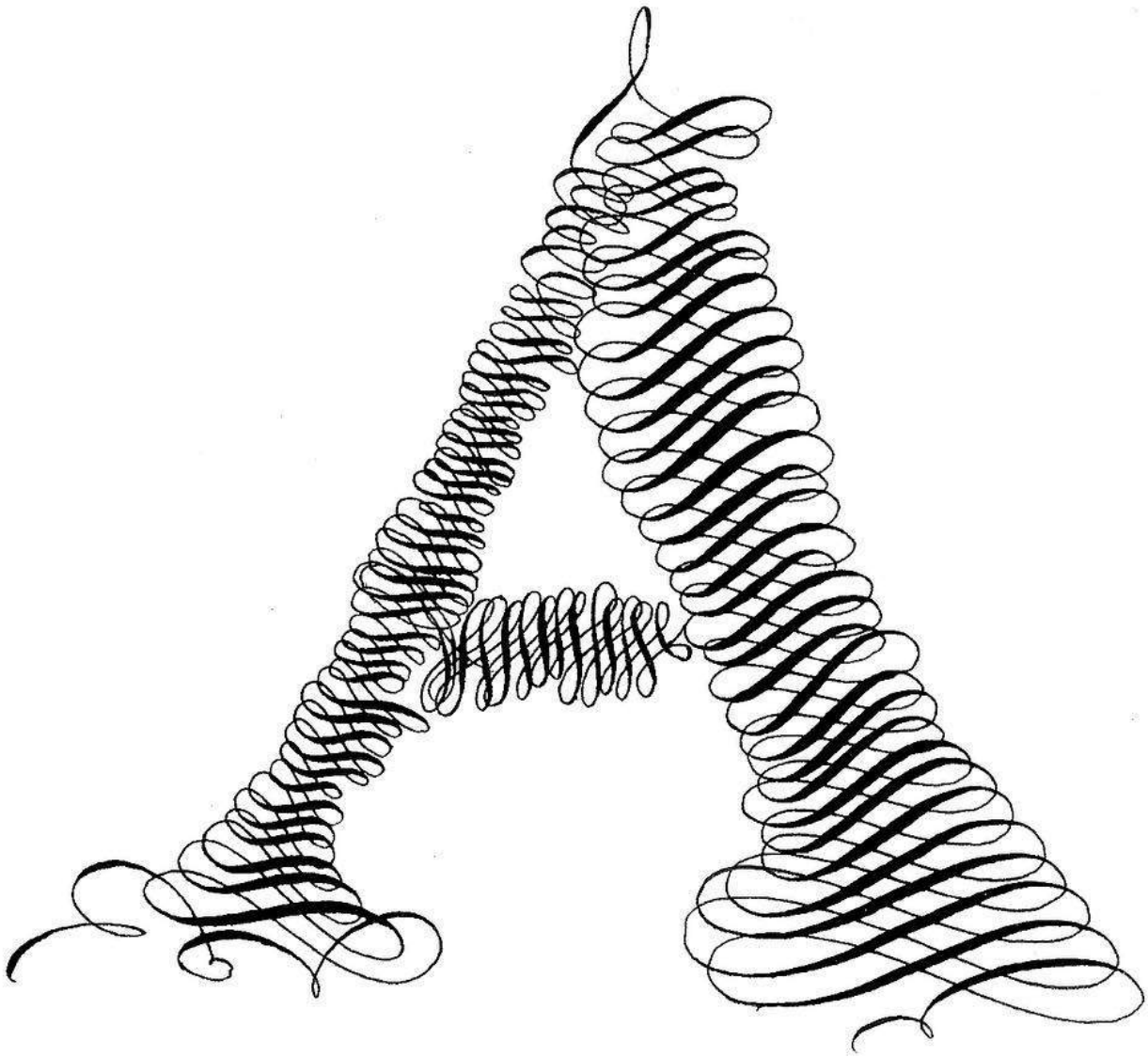
Choreo-graphy Alphabet
Christine Claussen
Alphabet generated through dance and choreography.
↳ choreo-graphy-alphabet.hfk-bremen.de
↳ christineclaussen.de
↳ instagram.com/p/DB_PocisGFW
↳ slanted.de/choreo-graphy-alphabet-a-graphic-dance-on-p…



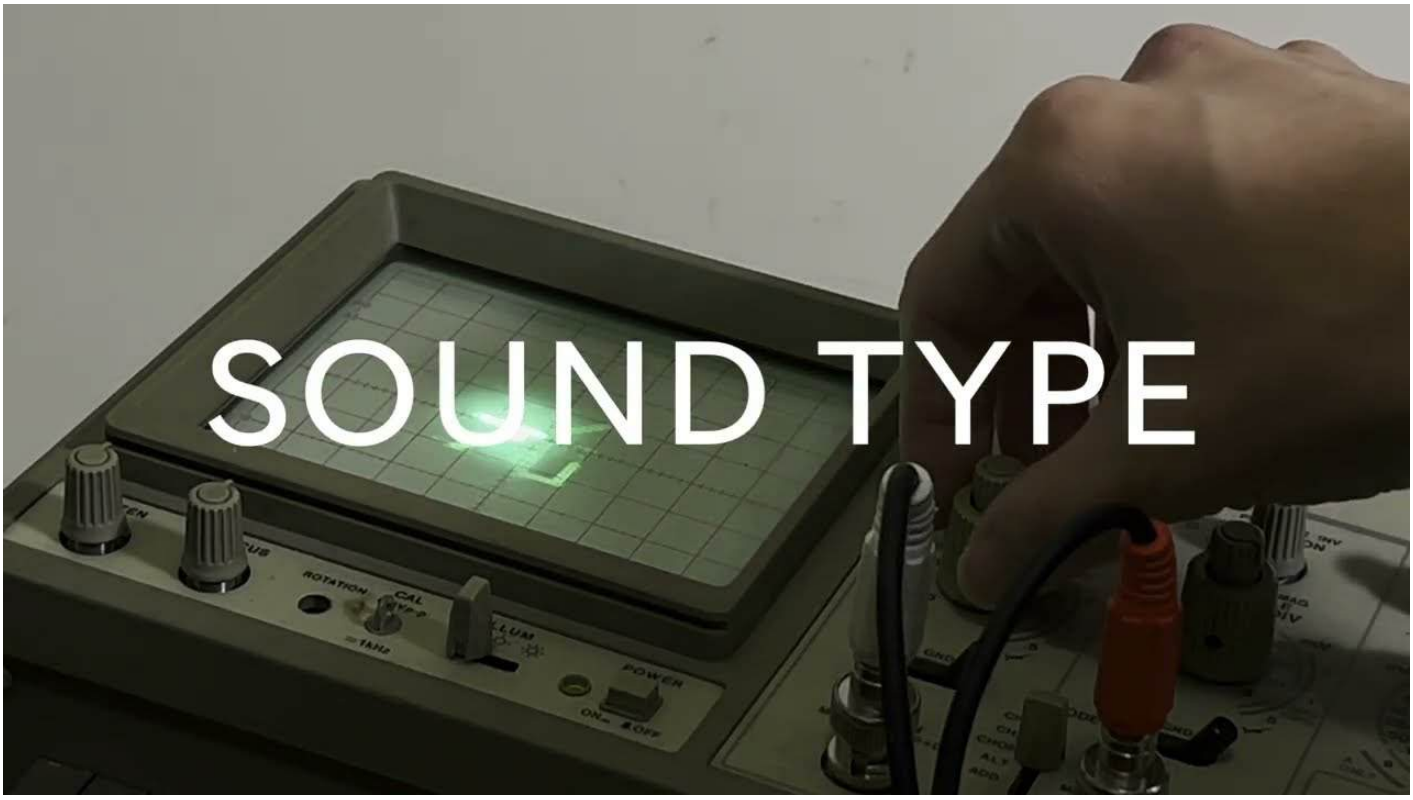
An Alphabetical Catwalk
Workshop by Tania Prill
↳ eyemagazine.com/blog/post/an-alphabetical-catwalk



Type of Motion
Katharina Nejdl
Pose-recognition as a tool for typographic design.
↳ katharinanejdl.com/typeofmotion



Zhenya Spizh
@spizh, London
Lettering
↳ instagram.com/p/BVZv7HYhqaM/?hl=en

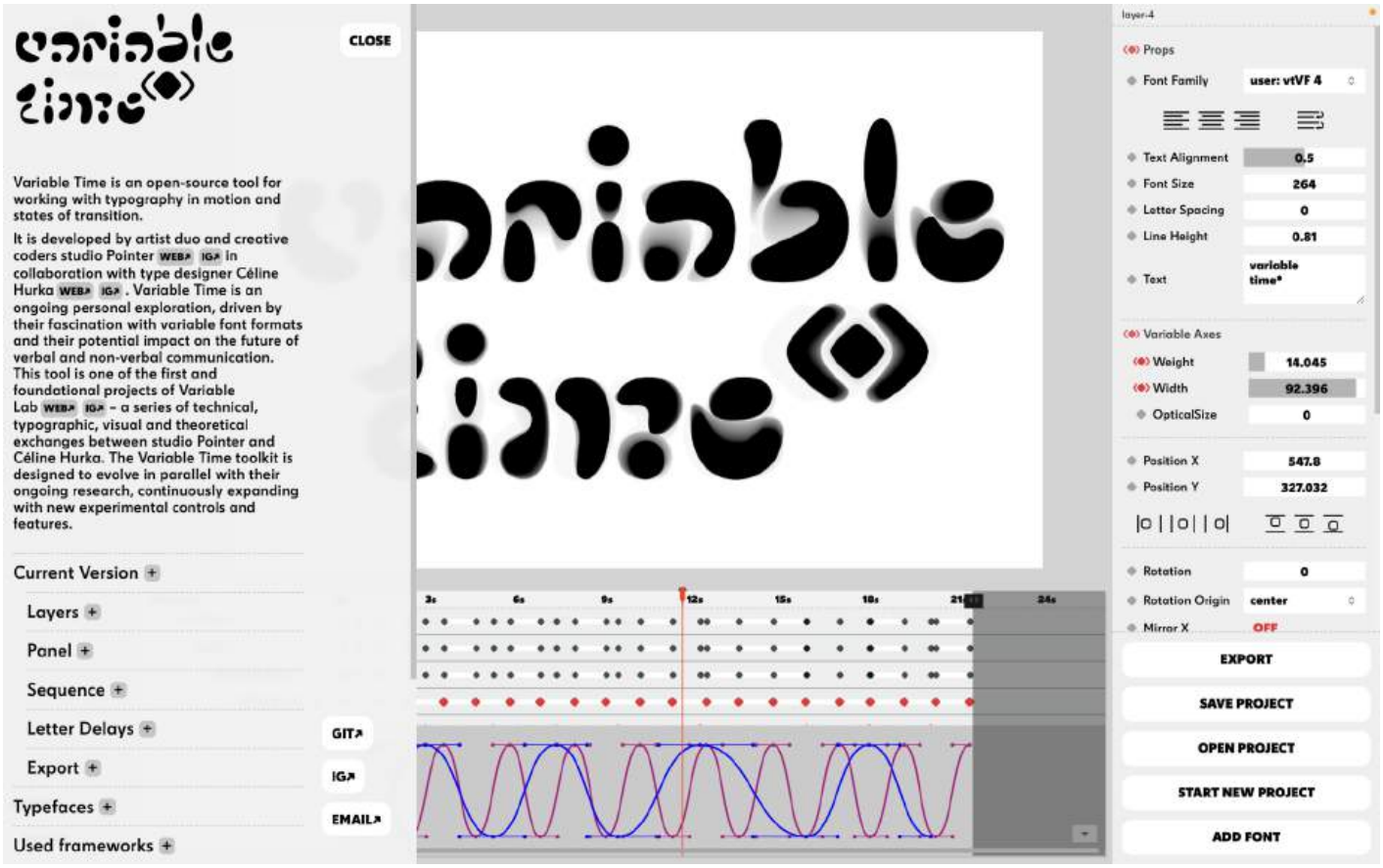


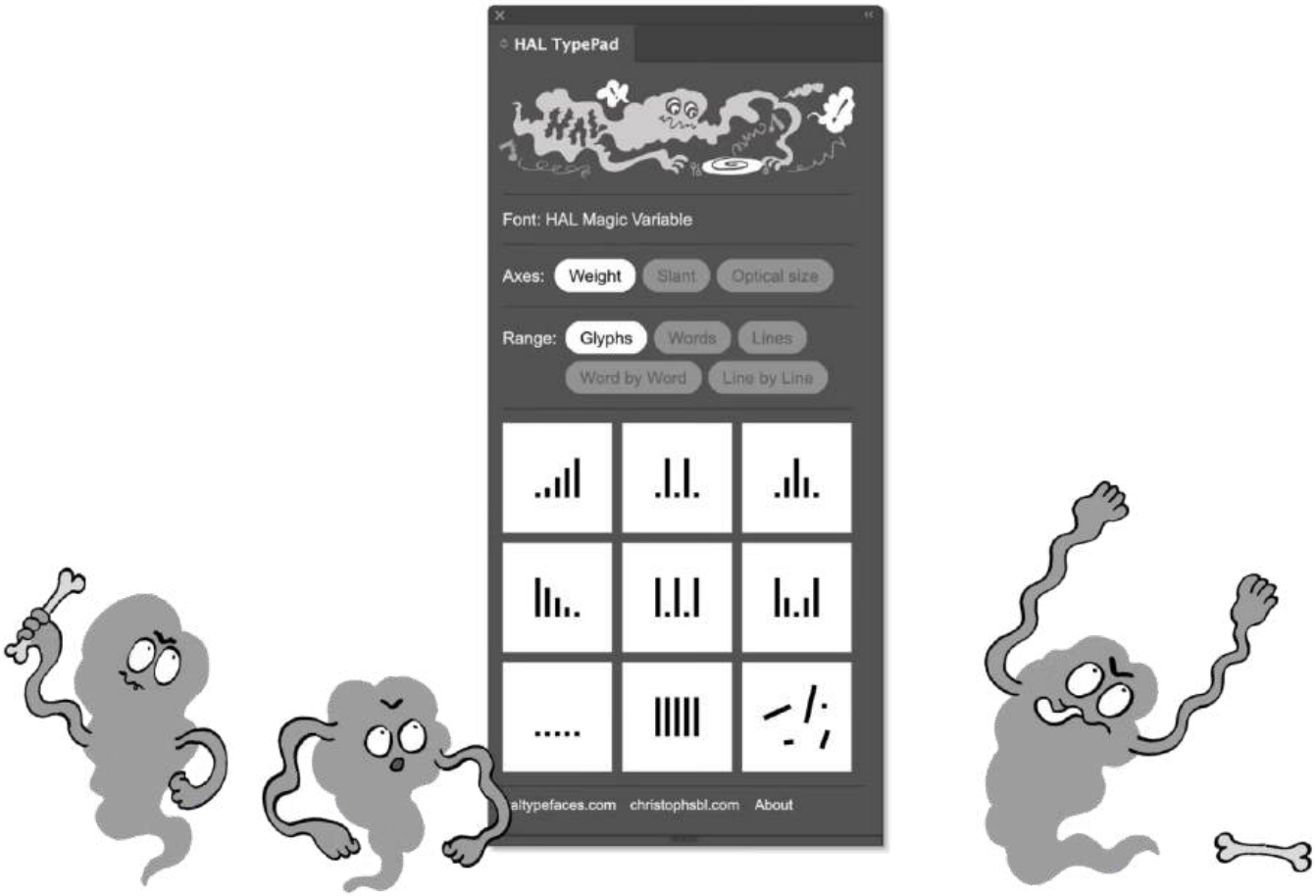
Blending Sound and Typography
Jonathan Mak
↳ youtube.com/watch?v=gVg6gkM6EqY&t=19s



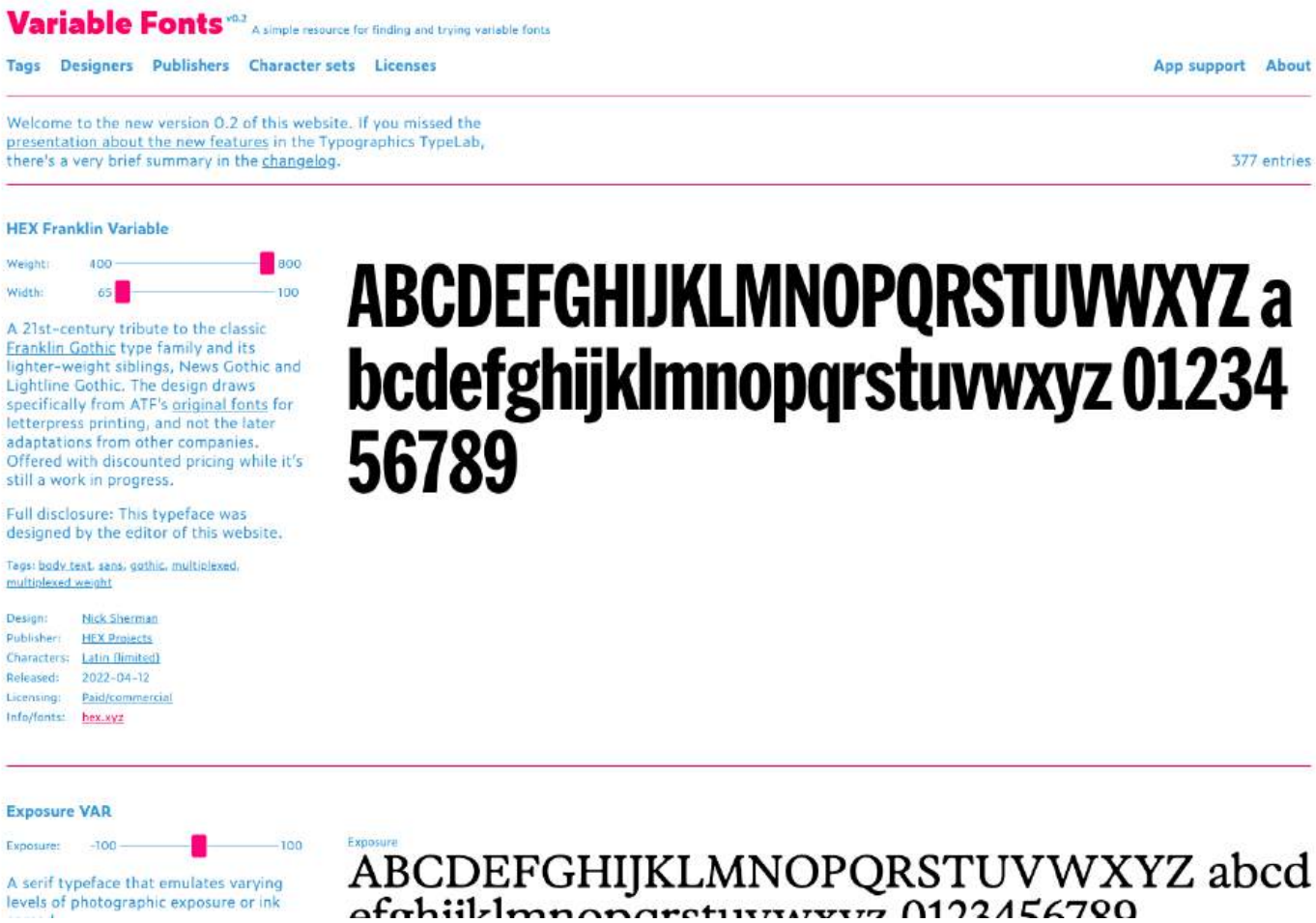


Kinetic Type
Holke79, Madrid
Kinetic typography and motion logotypes.
↳ holke79.com/project-kinetic-type.html

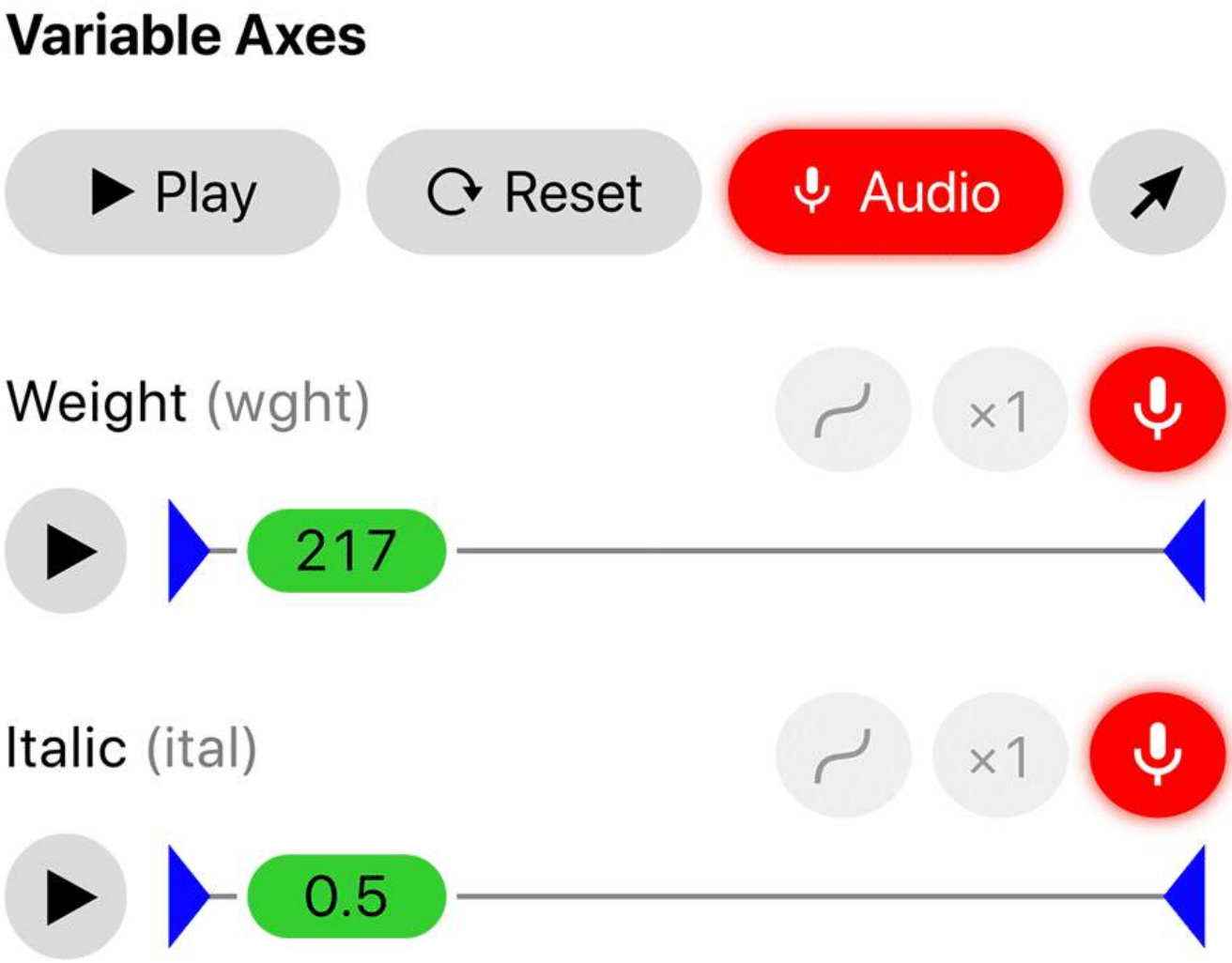

variable time
CLOSE
Variable Time is an open-source tool for working with typography in motion and states of transition.
It is developed by artist duo and creative coders studio Pointer WEB IG in collaboration with type designer Céline Hurka WEB IG . Variable Time is an ongoing personal exploration, driven by their fascination with variable font formats and their potential impact on the future of verbal and non-verbal communication. This tool is one of the first and foundational projects of Variable Lab WEB IG – a series of technical, typographic, visual and theoretical exchanges between studio Pointer and Céline Hurka. The Variable Time toolkit is designed to evolve in parallel with their ongoing research, continuously expanding with new experimental controls and features.
Current Version
Layers
Panel
Sequence
Letter Delays
Export
Typefaces
Used frameworks
GIT
IG
EMAIL
layer-4
Props
Font Family
user: vtVF 4
Text Alignment
0.5
Font Size
264
Letter Spacing
0
Line Height
0.81
Text
variable time*
Variable Axes
Weight
14.045
Width
92.396
OpticalSize
0
Position X
547.8
Position Y
327.032
Rotation
0
Rotation Origin
center
Mirror X
OFF
EXPORT
SAVE PROJECT
OPEN PROJECT
START NEW PROJECT
ADD FONT



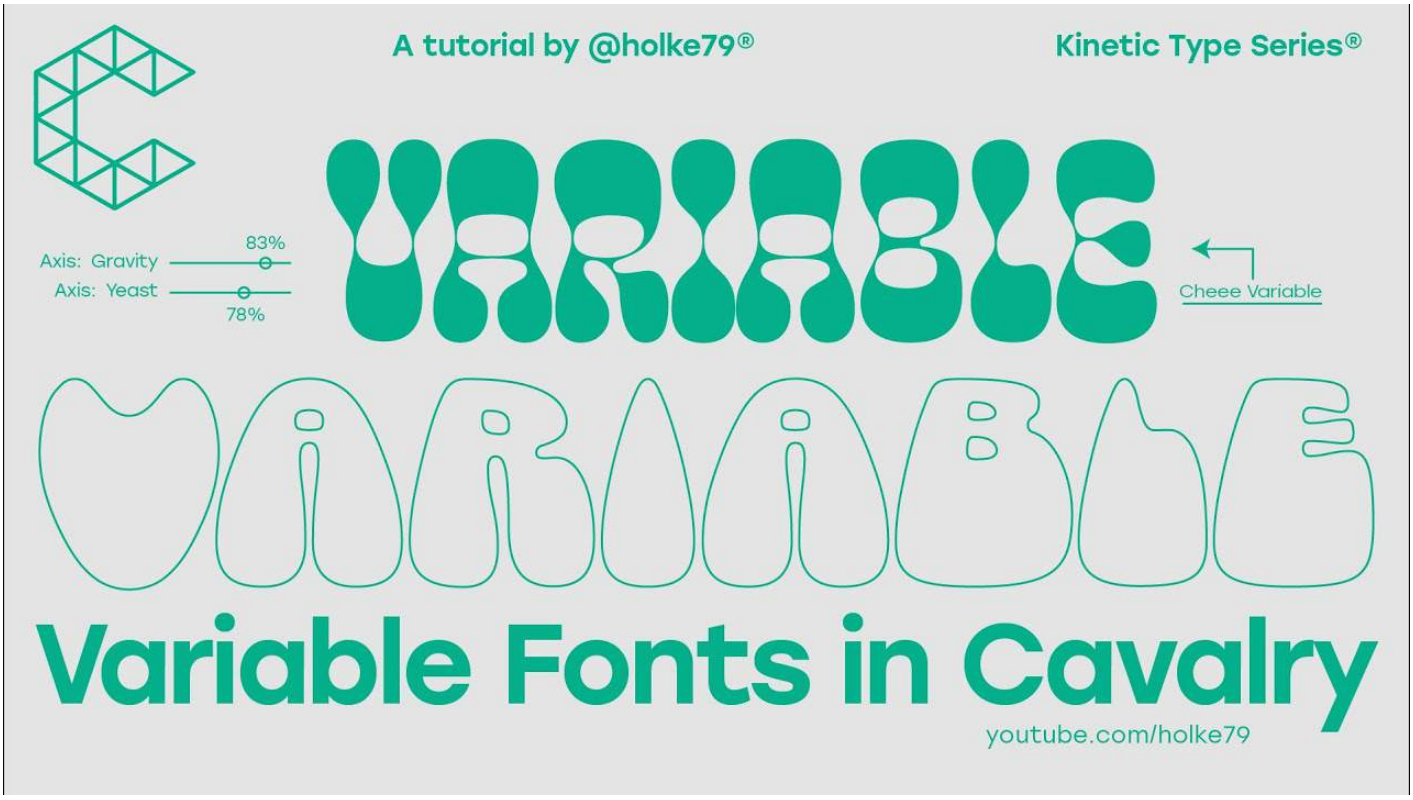
HAL Typepad
InDesign script for using Variable Typefaces experimentally
↳ haltypefaces.com/notes/typepad-manual



v-fonts
Nick Sherman
A list of variable fonts.
↳ v-fonts.com



Font Gauntlet
Dinamo
Proof, generate and animate variable fonts in the browser; axes can also be driven by microphone input.
↳ fontgauntlet.com



Animating Variable Fonts in Cavalry
Kinetic Type Series, Holke79 (see 1.11)
Video tutorial on animating variable font axes in the motion design software Cavalry.
↳ youtube.com/watch?v=D7ZtncvWtxU



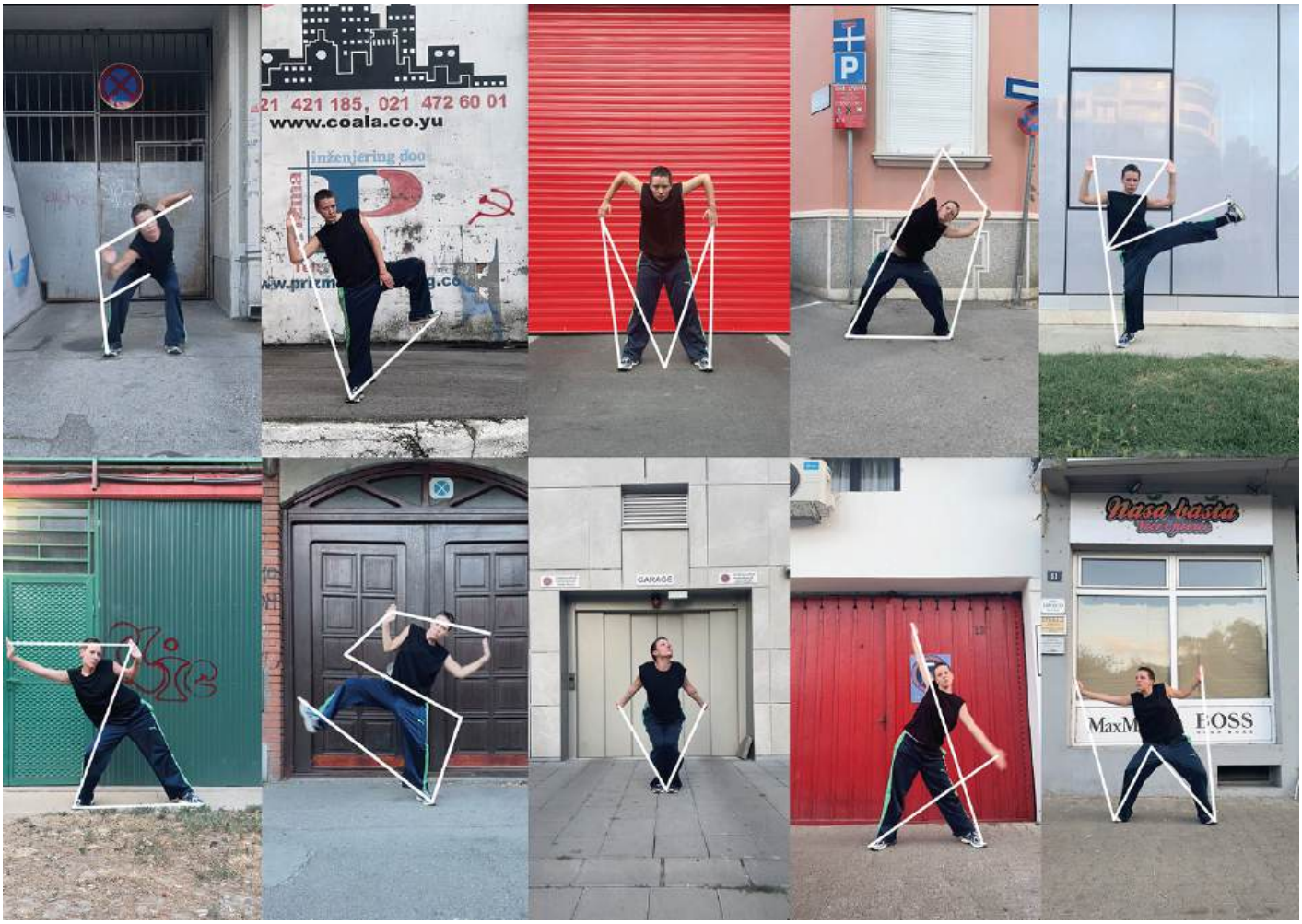
Menschenalphabet (Human Alphabet)
Peter Flötner (1534)
Renaissance woodcut alphabet of contorted nude bodies.
↳ The Human Alphabet (Public Domain Review) publicdomai…
↳ nuremberg.museum/projects/show/1433-the-human-alphabet



Abeceda | Alphabet
Karel Teige, Milča Mayerová, Vítězslav Nezval (1926)
Choreographed alphabet: dancer Milča Mayerová poses each letter.
↳ typeroom.eu/dance-for-type-karel-teige's-avant-garde-c…



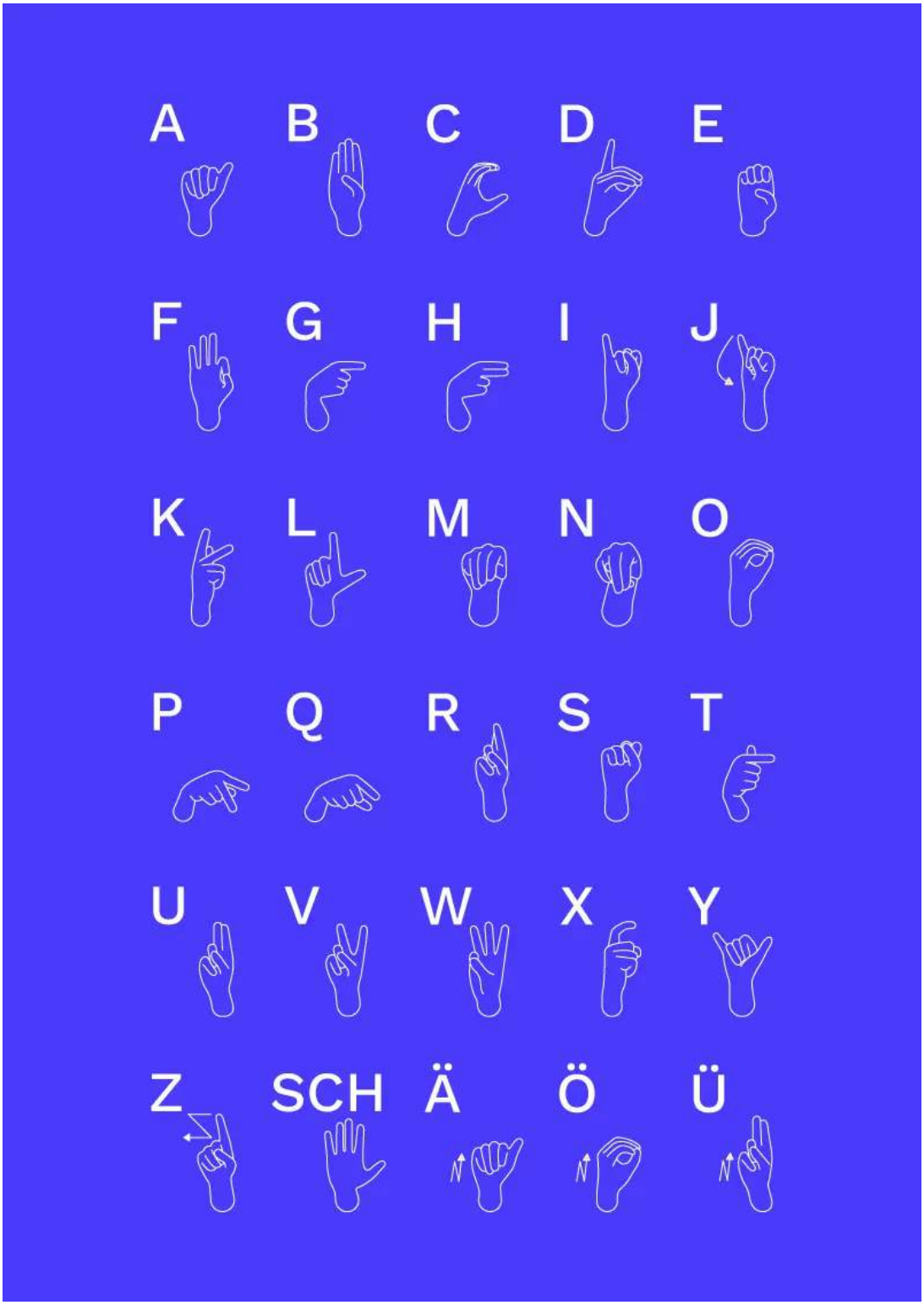
Alphabet (2005/12)
Paulina Ołowska
Performance after Mayerová's Abeceda *(see 2.02), using the body to construct letterforms.*
↳ clairebishop.commons.gc.cuny.edu/projects/paulina-olow…
↳ archiwum.artmuseum.pl/en/doc/video-alfabet-pauliny-olo…
↳ mimosahouse.co.uk/2019/2019/10/13/paulina-olowska-perf…



kinesics.regular
Jane Berezhna (Tokyo TDC Prize 2026)
Synthesis of choreography and typography based on improvisational dance: letters take on the emotional and kinetic qualities of the moving body.
↳ tokyotypedirectorsclub.org/en/award/2026_tdc_04

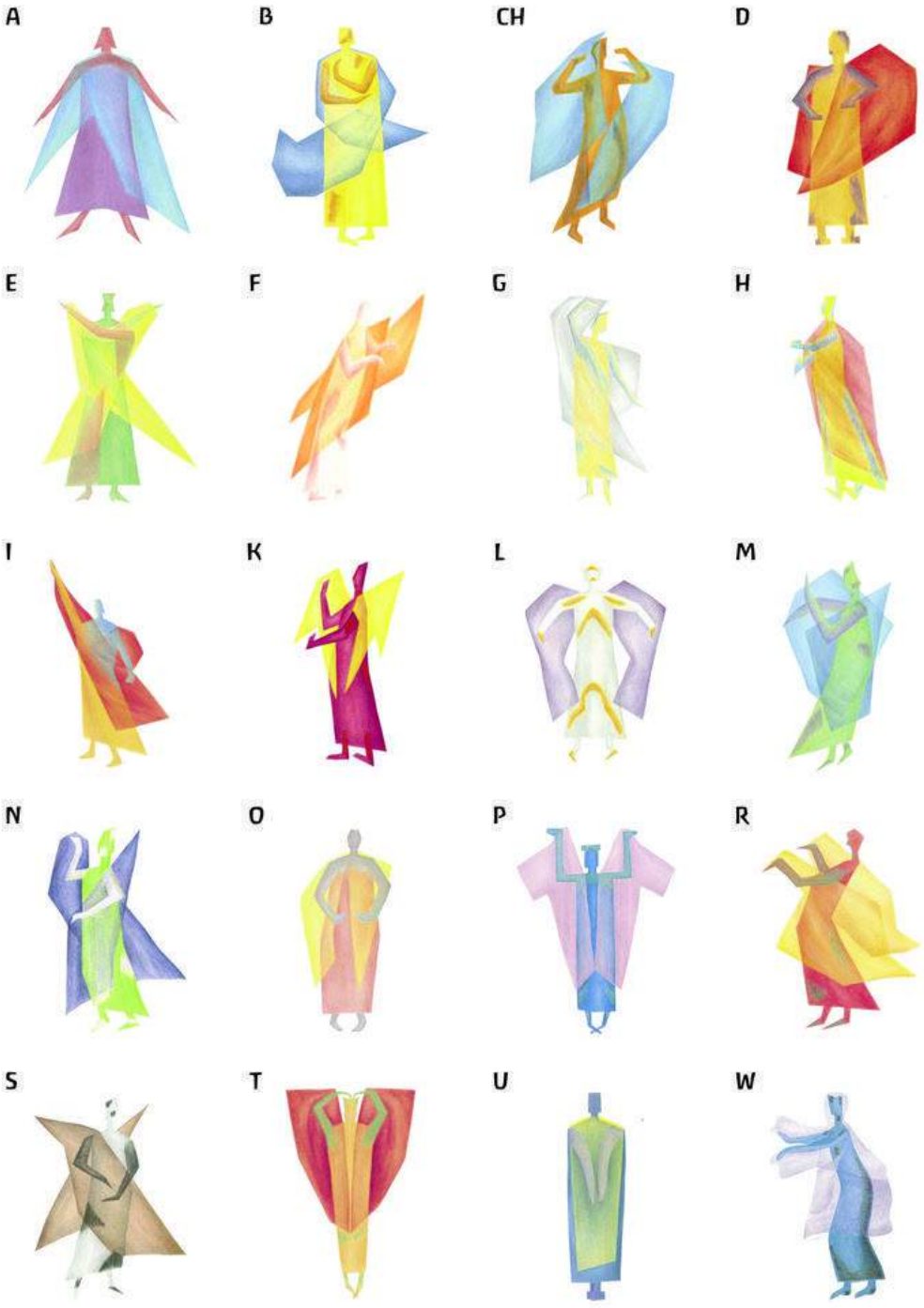


Dance the Alphabet
↳ youtube.com/watch?v=VloEiK4Ihj8



Sign Language "A–Z" (Gebärdensprache)
Fingerspelling alphabet
↳ youtube.com/watch?v=SI5yLJ2MyoM

EURYTHMY FIGURES



Eurythmy (Eurythmie)
Expressive movement originated by the (controversial) Rudolf Steiner.
↳ youtube.com/watch?v=ROB7gJMZmUE



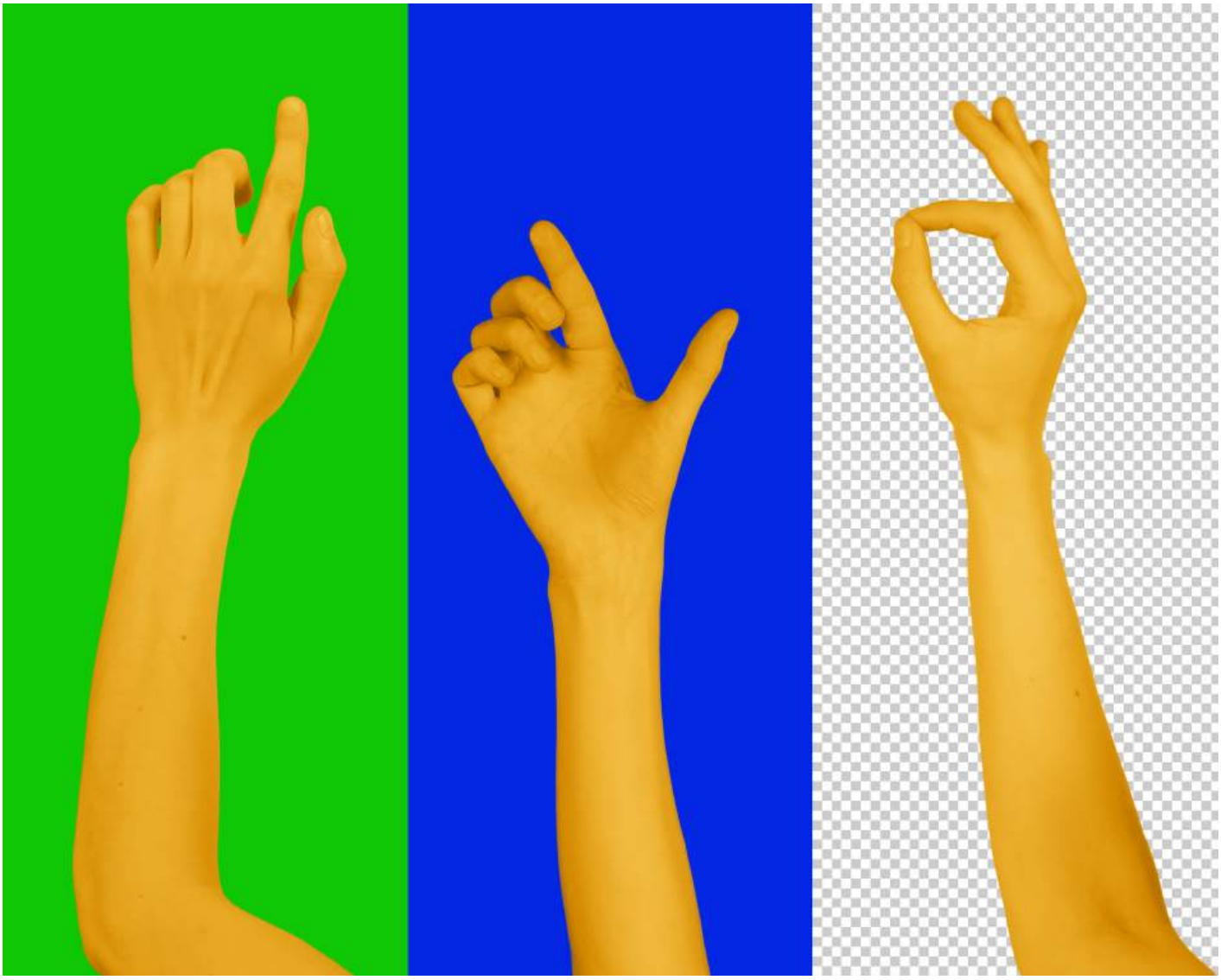
Grimassenalphabet
Frieder Butzmann
in: Typografie als künstlerisches Ereignis *(Typography as Artistic Event) — Glasmeier, Prill (eds.), Textem*
↳ friederbutzmann.de/bios



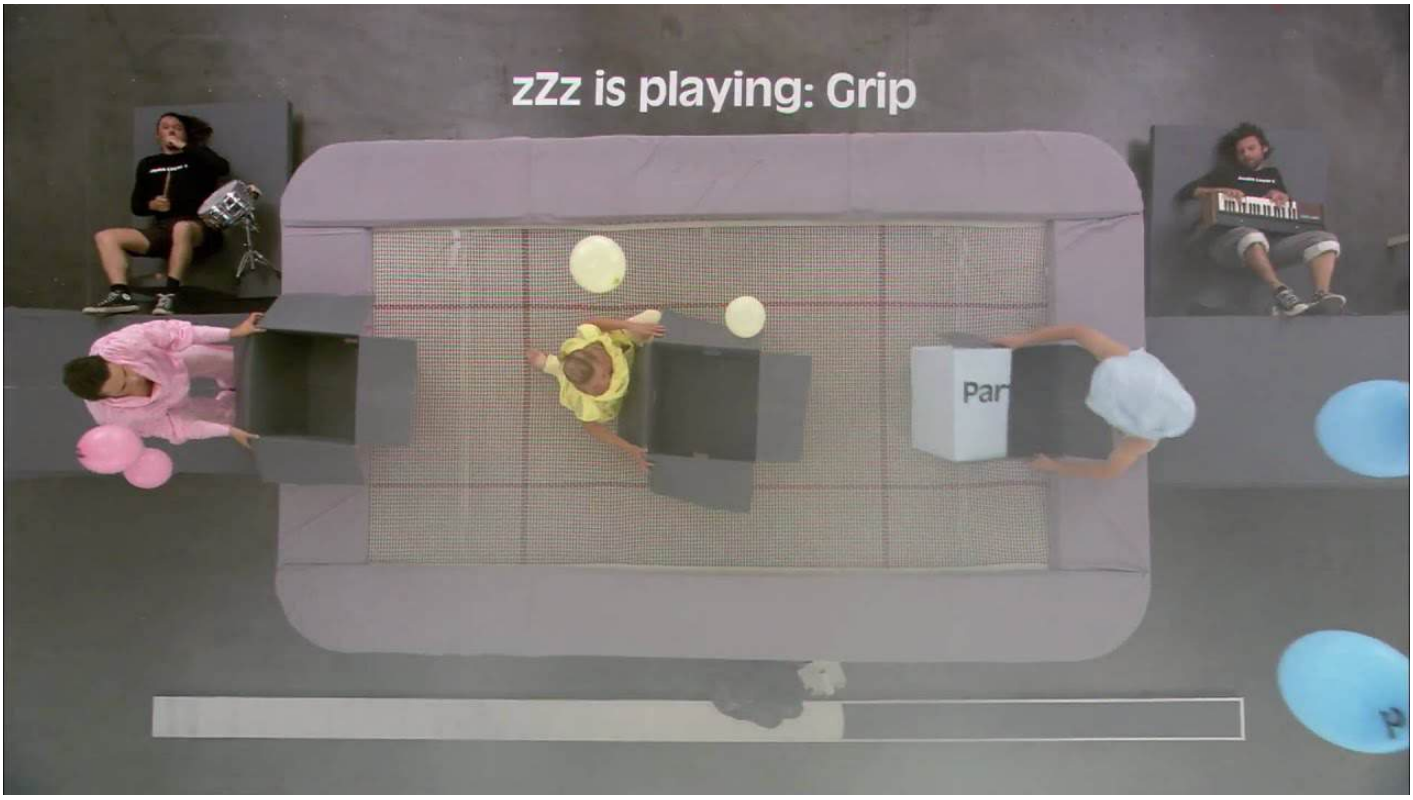
Conditional Design
Studio Moniker
Designing by strict, analogue rules of movement.
↳ conditionaldesign.org



Out of Pattern
Luna Maurer
Design & choreography research.
↳ outofpattern.dance/info
↳ lunamaurer.com/talkdance-gathering



Gestures Video Assets
Studio Moniker
↳ Video Assets shop.studiomoniker.com/product/gestures-…
↳ Font gestures.studiomoniker.com



zZz is playing: Grip
Roel Wouters
↳ youtube.com/watch?v=gI04Nrz364M
↳ Making of 1 youtube.com/watch?v=Ptpq082LG-k
↳ Making of 2 youtube.com/watch?v=hJQMIfPrUZs





Angela Lian
Graphic design combining choreography, performance, and typography.
↳ itsnicethat.com/articles/nicer-tuesdays-new-york-june-…



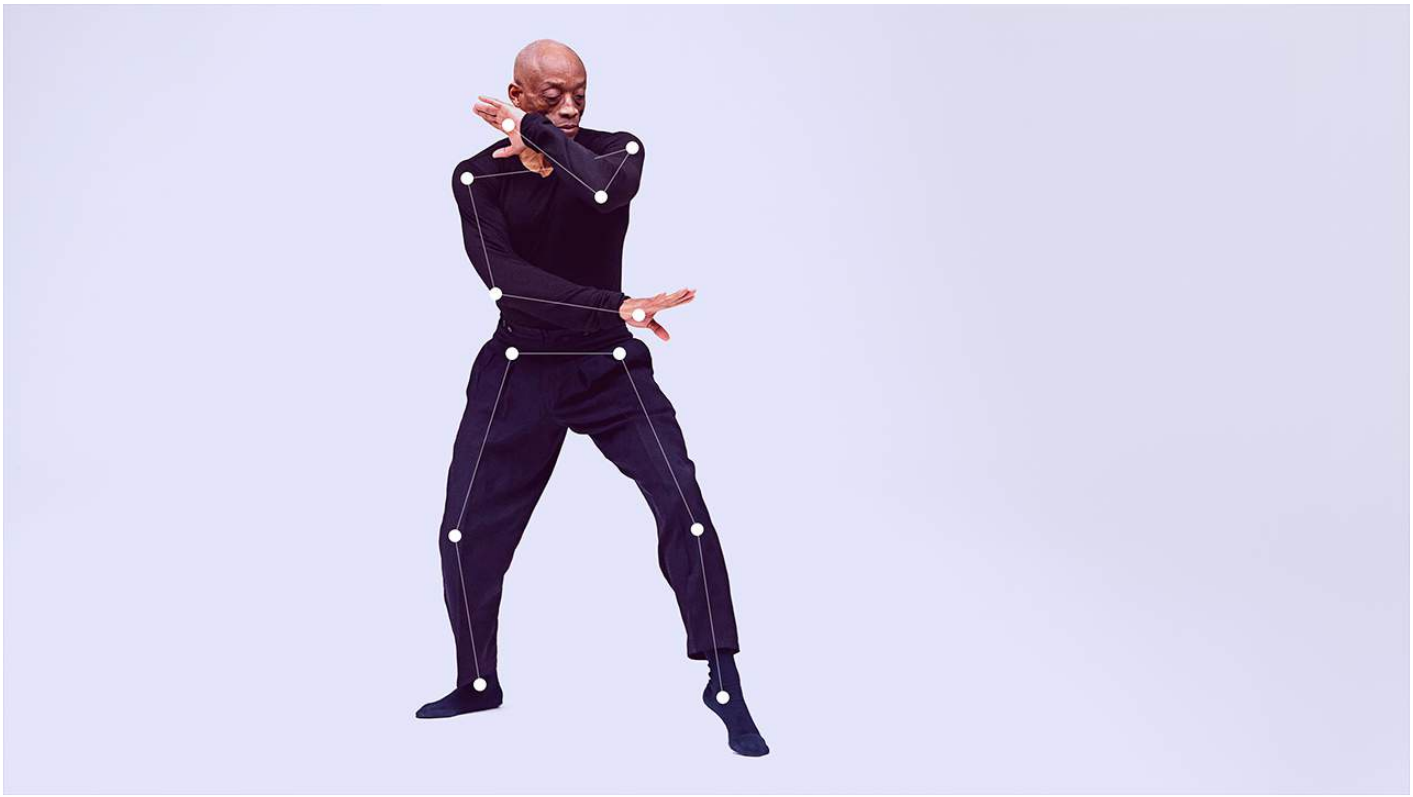
Kyla Arsadjaja
Playful graphic systems combining movement and typography.
↳ itsnicethat.com/articles/kyla-arsadjaja-graphic-design…



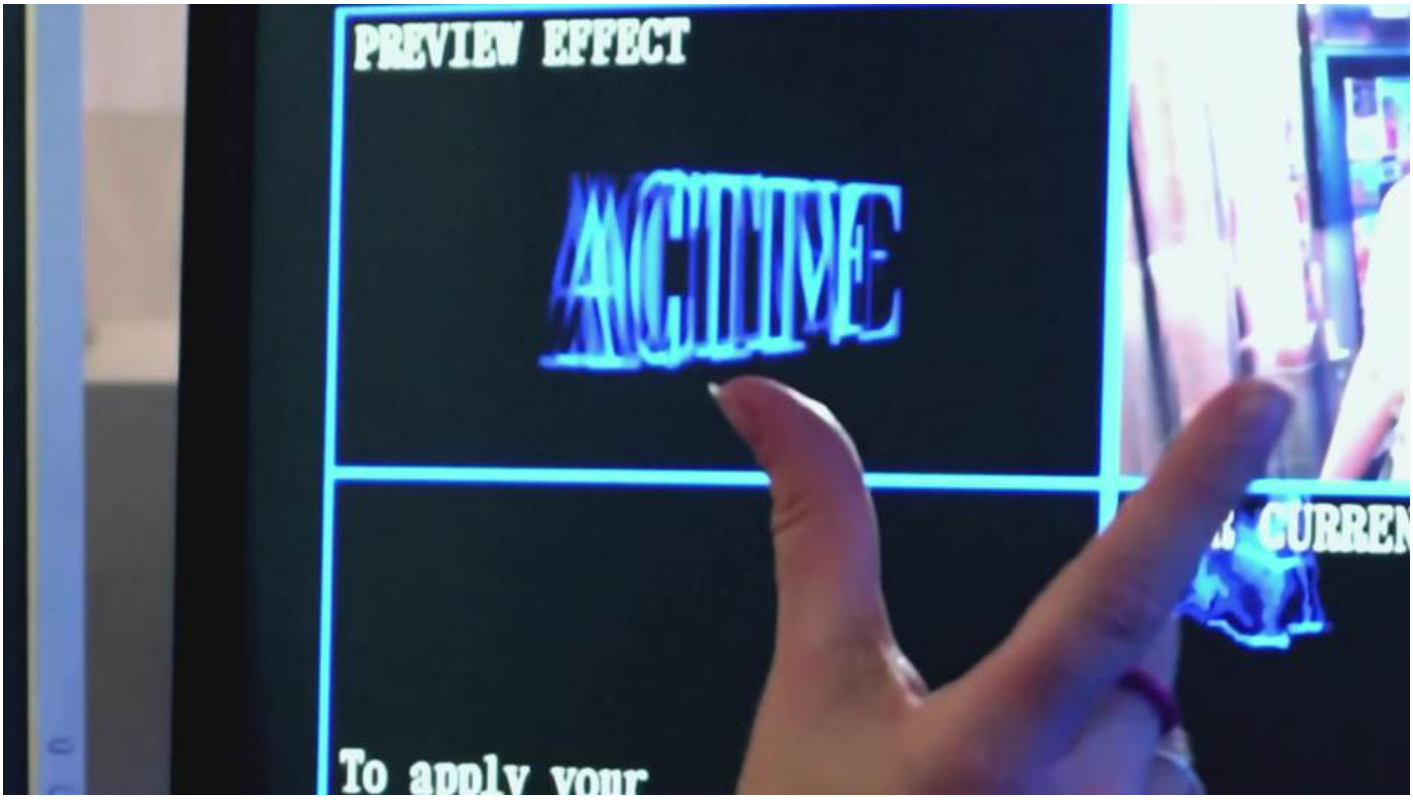
Body Experimental Type
Haocheng Zhang
Experimental typography created through body and gesture.
↳ haochengstudio.com
↳ itsnicethat.com/articles/haocheng-zhang-body-experimen…



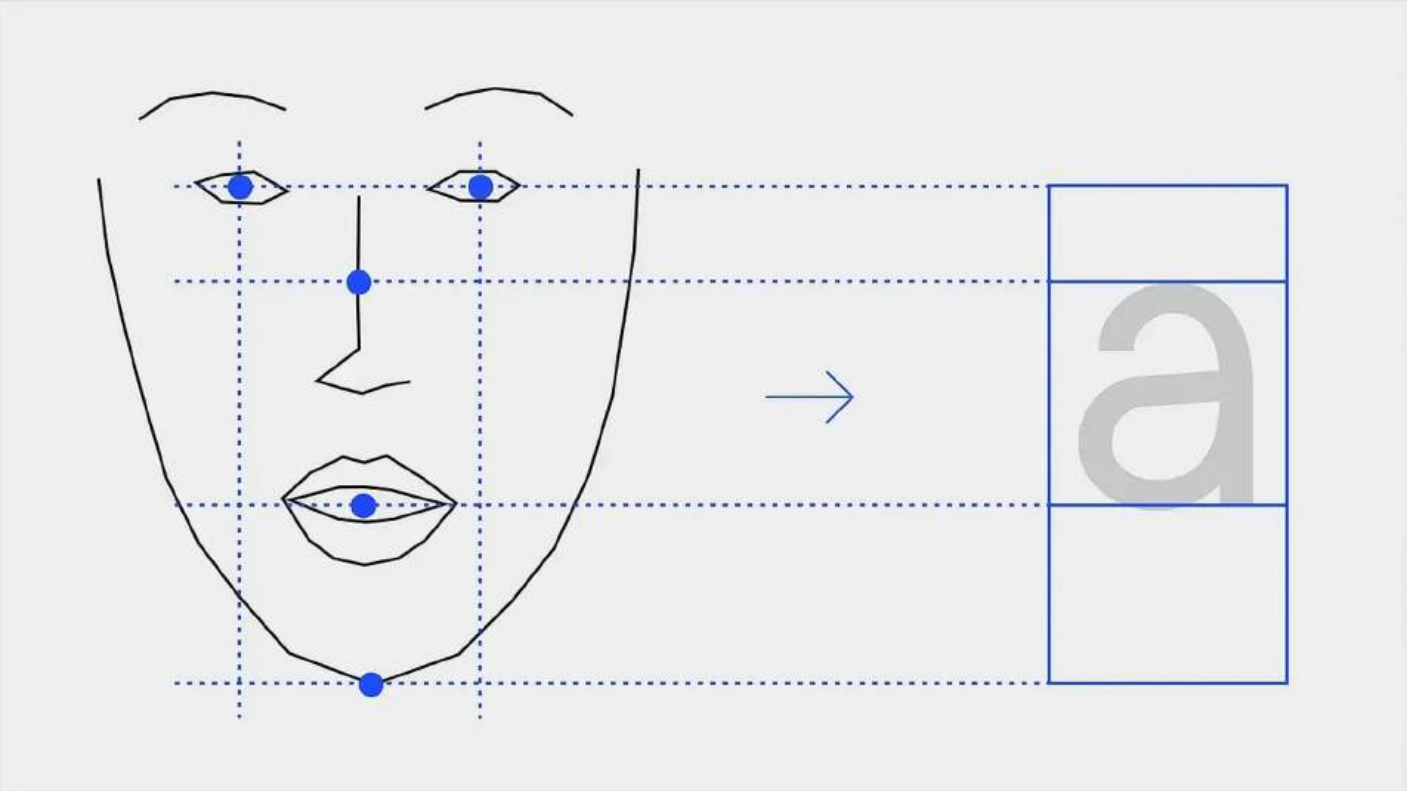
Text Rain
Camille Utterback (1999)
Interactive installation where falling letters respond to the body.
↳ camilleutterback.com/projects/text-rain



Body, Movement, Language: AI Sketches with Bill T. Jones
Bill T. Jones & Google Creative Lab (2019)
Experiments with pose estimation (PoseNet) that let speech and movement generate and animate words in the browser.
↳ experiments.withgoogle.com/billtjonesai



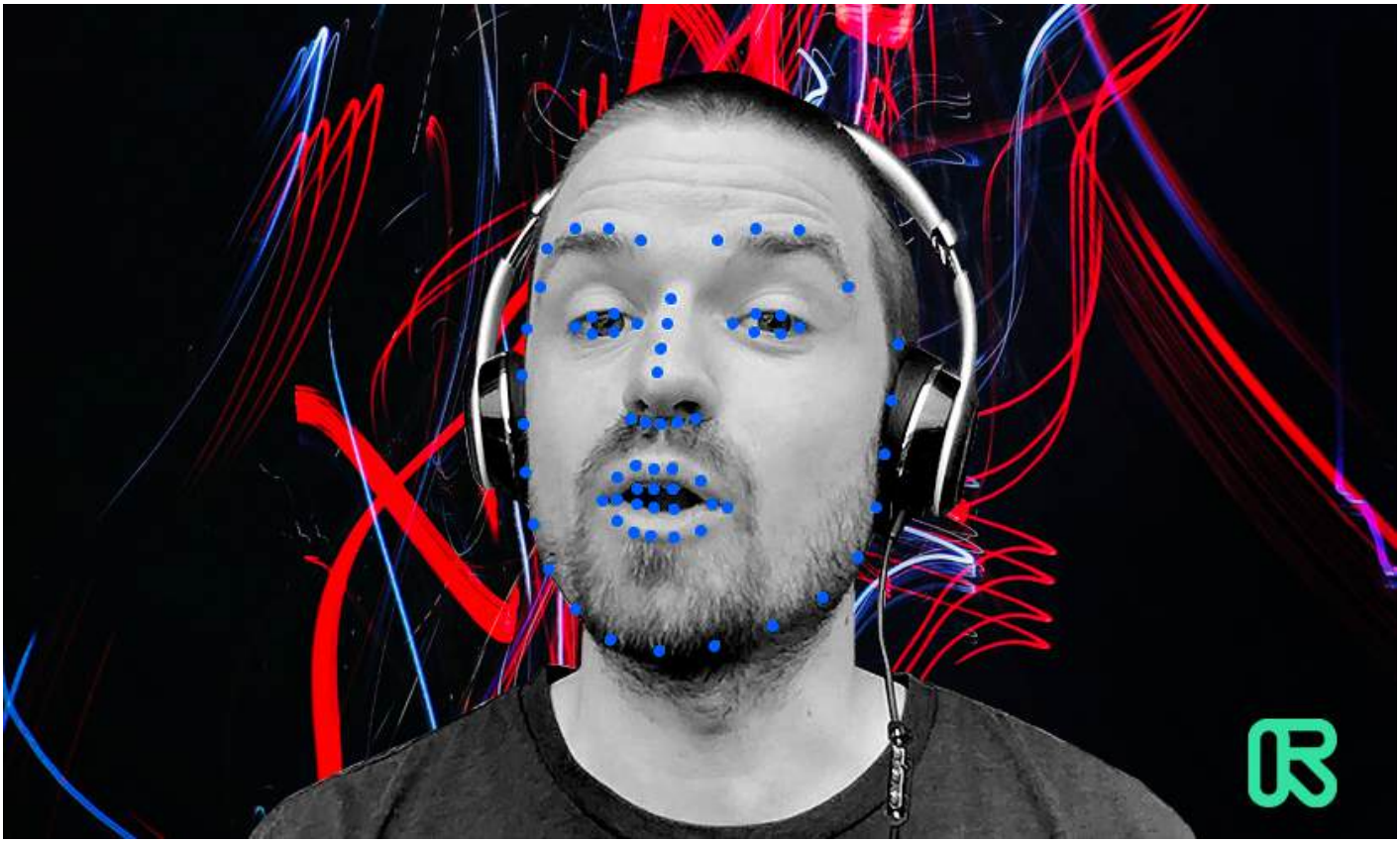
Active Motion
Carla Deyerberg
Installation in which type reacts to the body, built with TouchDesigner and motion tracking.
↳ youtube.com/watch?v=yYHtFCeV1m8



Open Type Face
Jean Böhm
Typeface controlled through facial expressions.
↳ jeanboehm.de/work/open-type-face



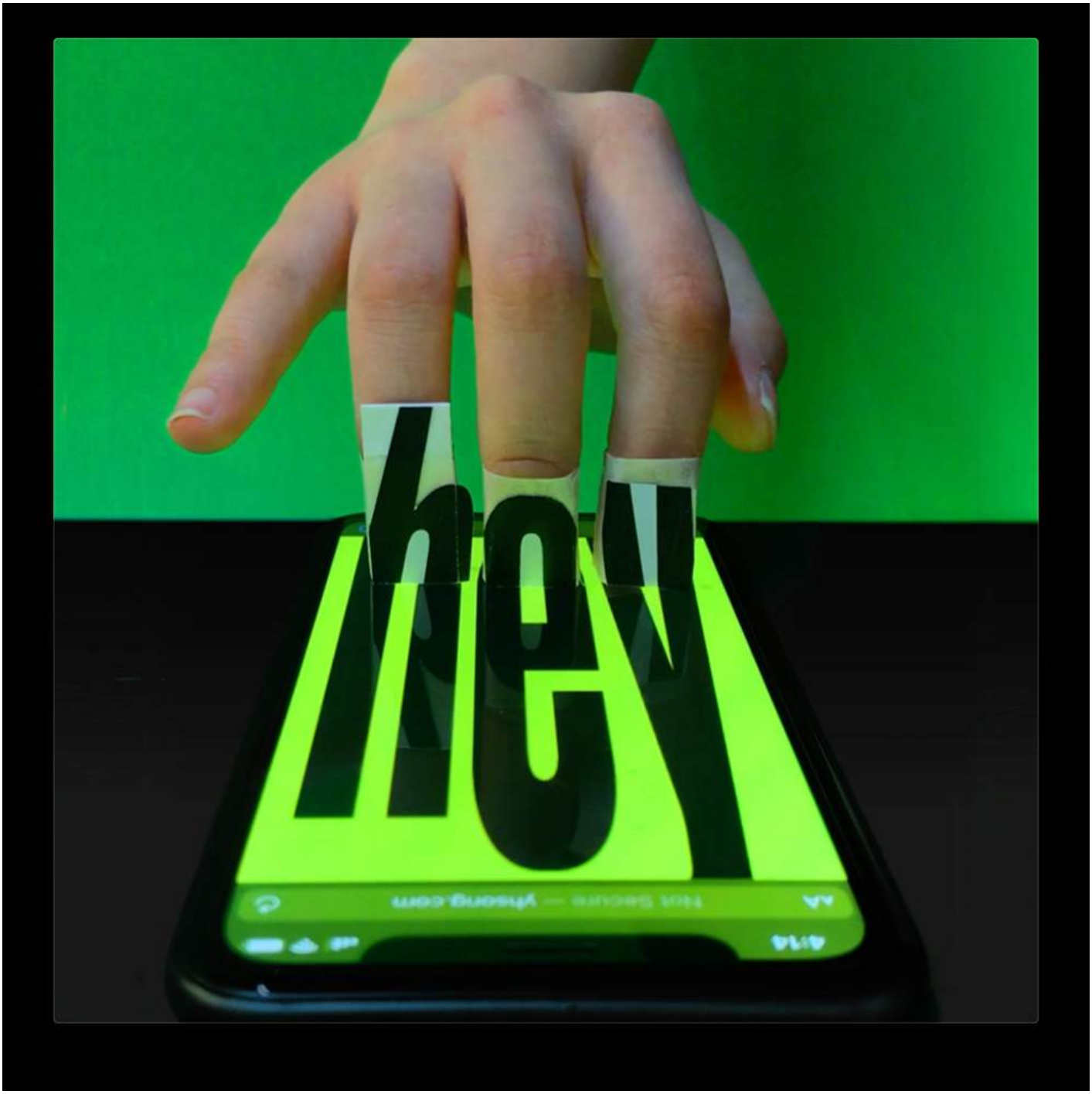
Facetype
Adam Lenzinger
A variable font driven by facial expressions.
↳ recordings.designmatters.io/can-you-control-a-typeface…



Andreas Refsgaard
Interactive alphabets: opening the mouth, shaking the head or hand gestures control or draw letters.
↳ andreasrefsgaard.dk/projects/words-from-another-mouth



Speaking with Your Hands
Vera van de Seyp
Gesture-controlled typography using pose estimation.
↳ instagram.com/p/DJGzWIsiTPY/?hl=en&img_index=2
↳ KABK Workshop kabk.nl/nieuws/project-week-being-human…


hey



Lab
Nahuel Gerth
Interactive typography and creative coding.
↳ nahuelgerth.de/lab
↳ nahuelgerth.de/lab/dance-and-flow
↳ nahuelgerth.de/lab/36-days-of-type
↳ nahuelgerth.de/lab/bodyartlab



Zach Lieberman
↳ zachlieberman.medium.com/daily-sketching-in-2021-fc922…



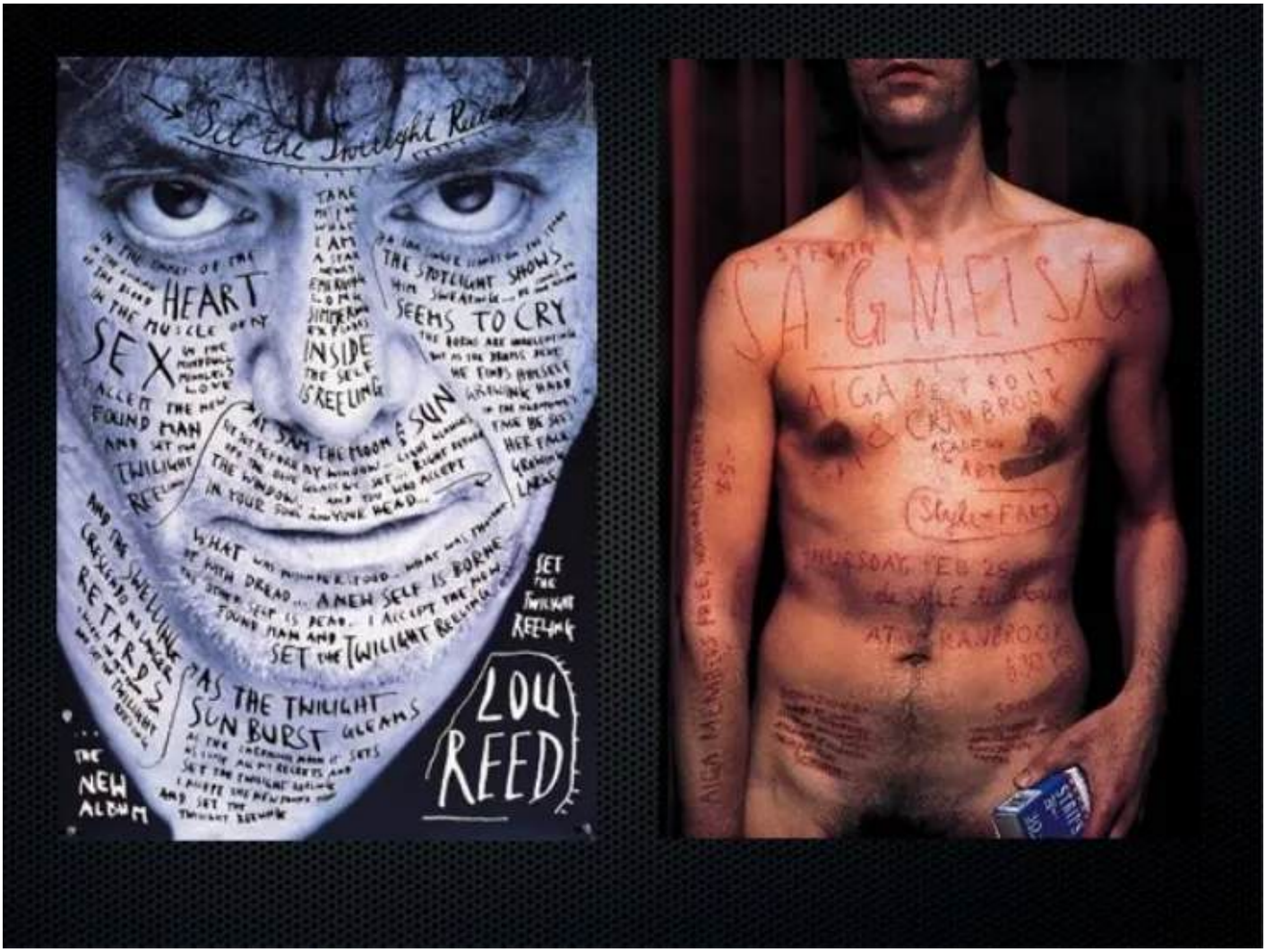
Choreographic Coding
Research connecting choreography and computational thinking.
↳ choreographiccoding.org



Space Type Generator
Kiel D. Mutschelknaus
Browser tools for kinetic type.
↳ spacetypegenerator.com
↳ Interview (type-01) type-01.com/kiel-mutschelknaus-on…



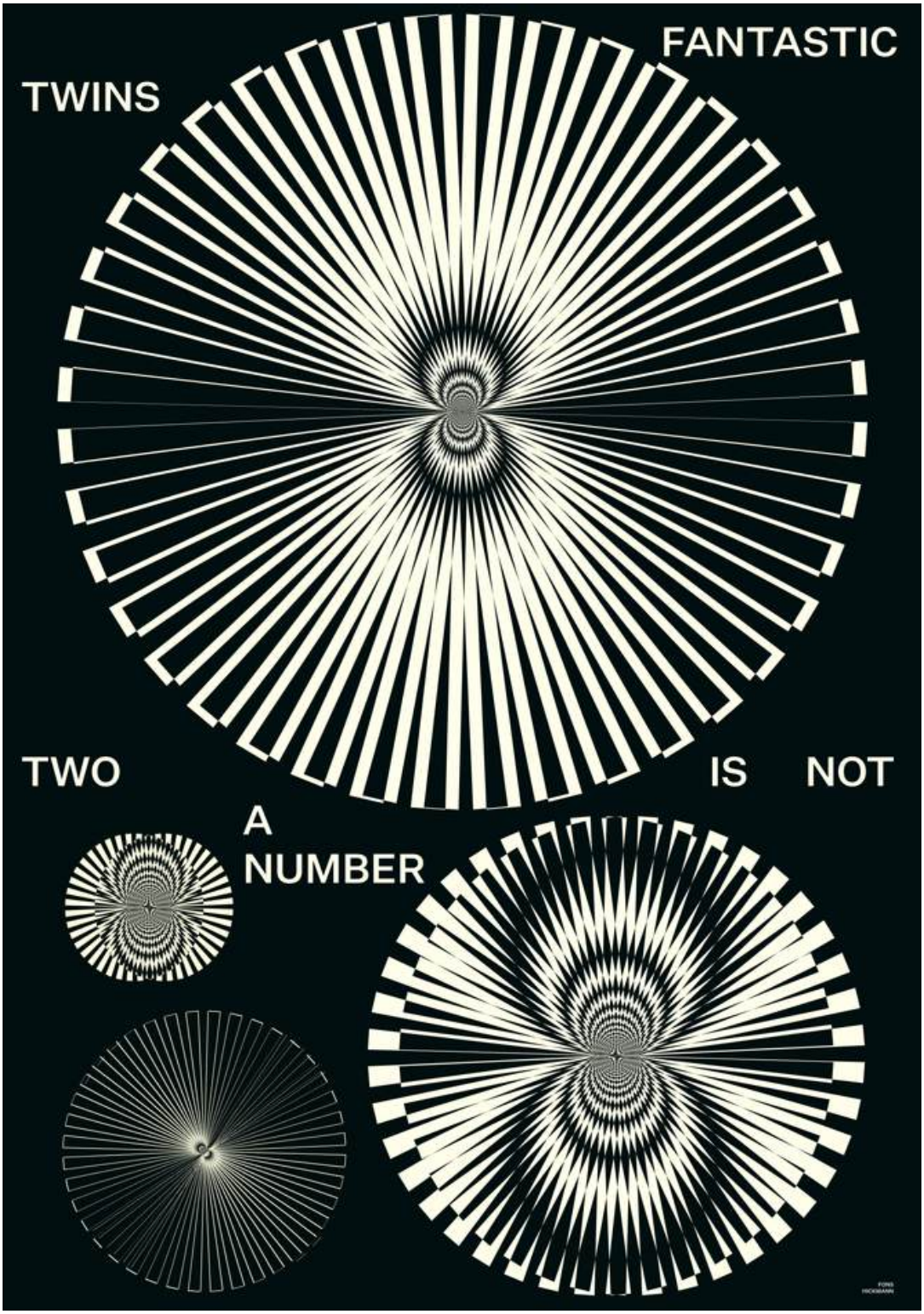
Pose-Recognition
Tutorials for Cavalry animations, body-tracking in the browser and in TouchDesigner.
↳ Pose Estimation with ml5.js – The Coding Train youtub…
↳ Motion Tracking with TouchDesigner & MediaPipe – The I…



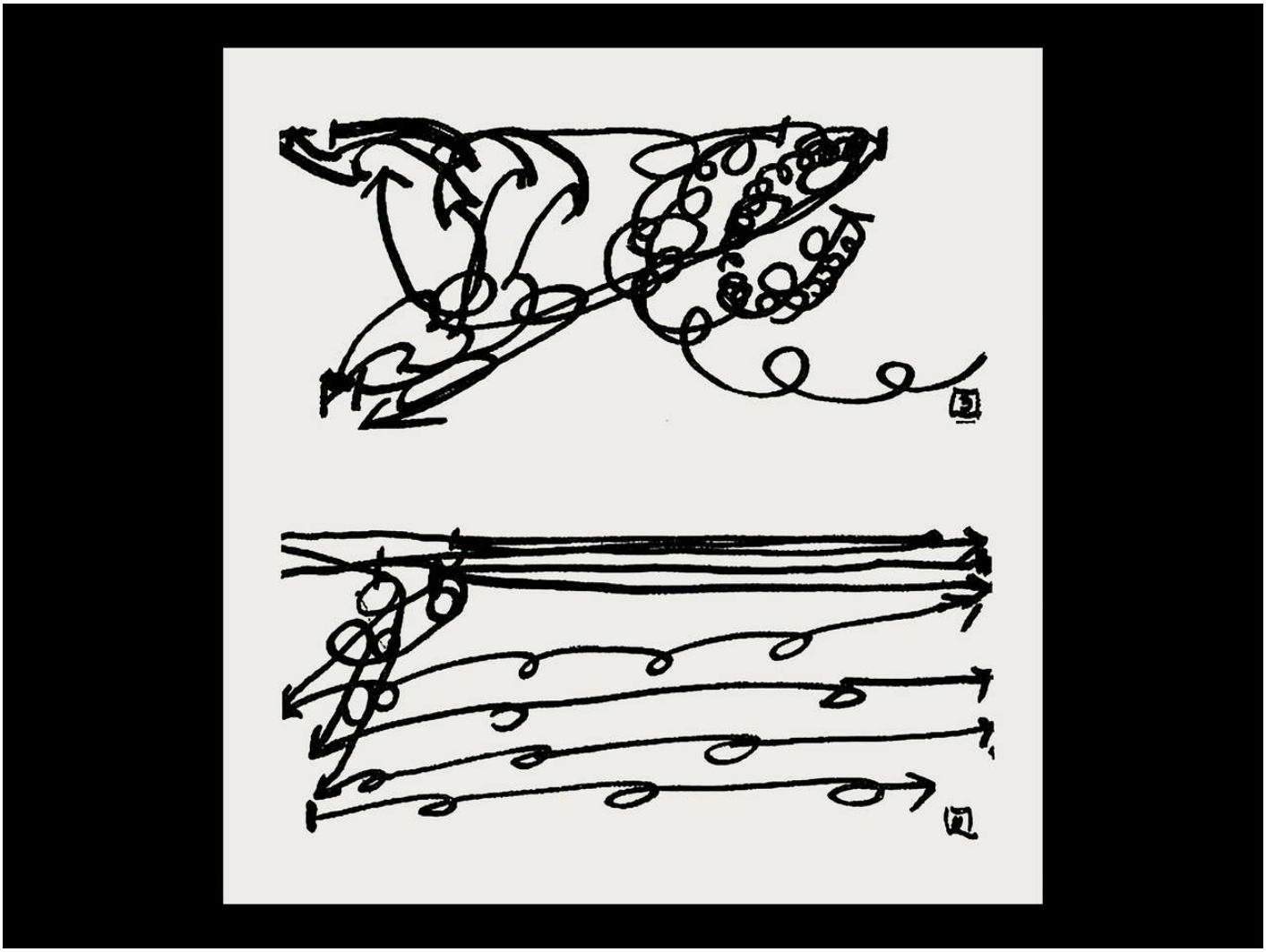
I Look Like This
Stefan Sagmeister (Sagmeister & Walsh)
Typography integrated with the designer's body.
↳ typographicposters.com/stefan-sagmeister-i-look-like-t…



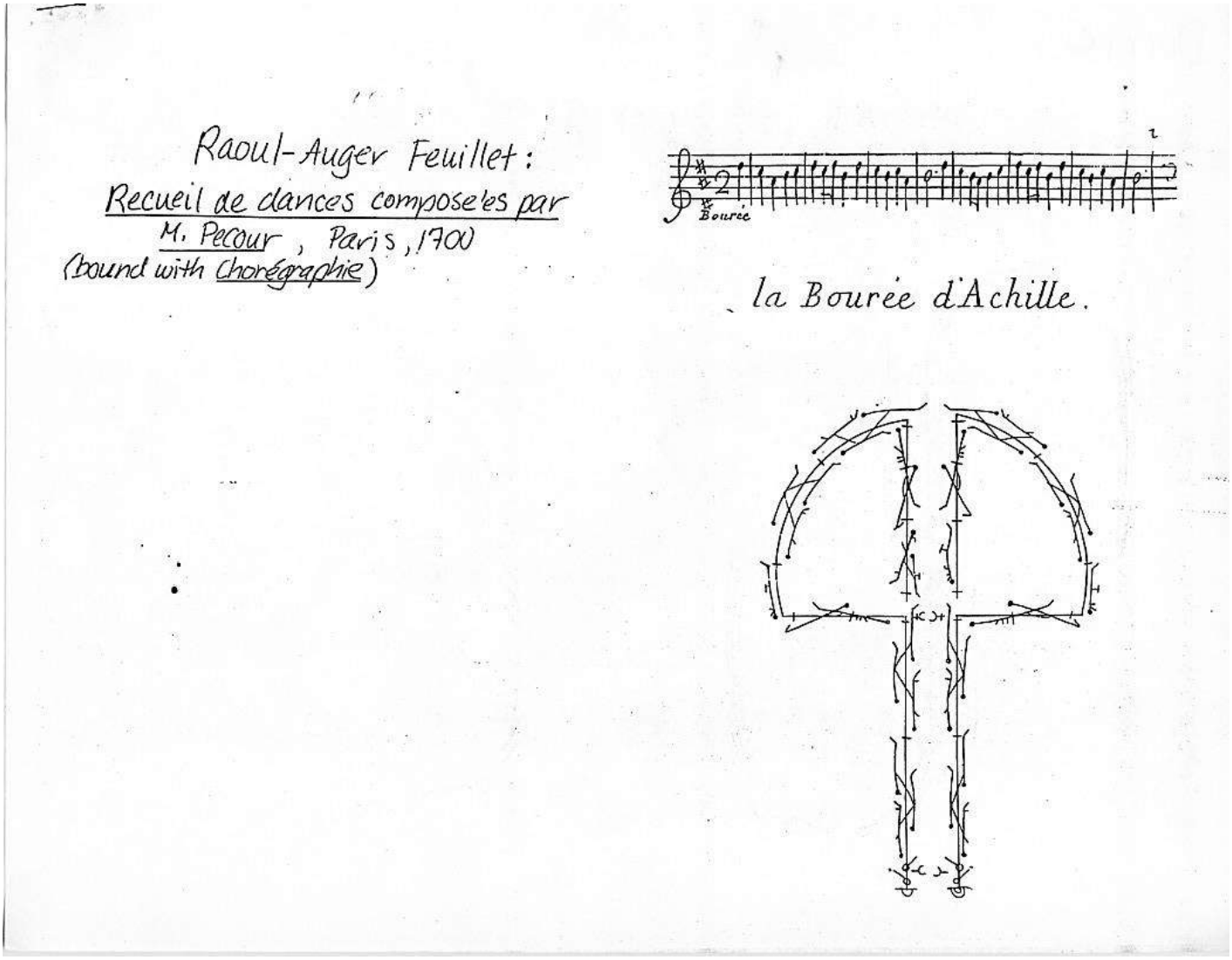
Typography Bodypainting
Aizone
Body painting used as typographic composition.
↳ whudat.de/typography-bodypainting-by-aizone-8-pictures



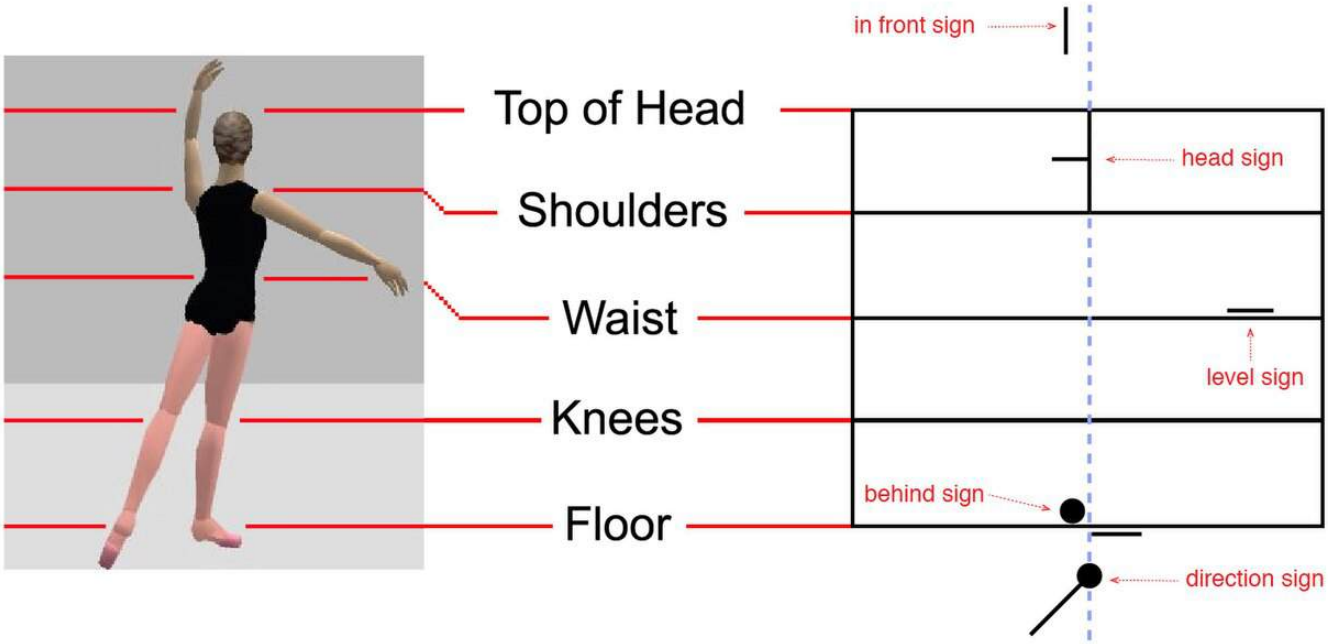
Typographic Posters Collection
Archive of expressive typography.
↳ Movement typographicposters.com/collections/6228e77a8…
↳ Body typographicposters.com/collections/6221fb34a354f…
↳ Dance typographicposters.com/collections/624d980126e5…



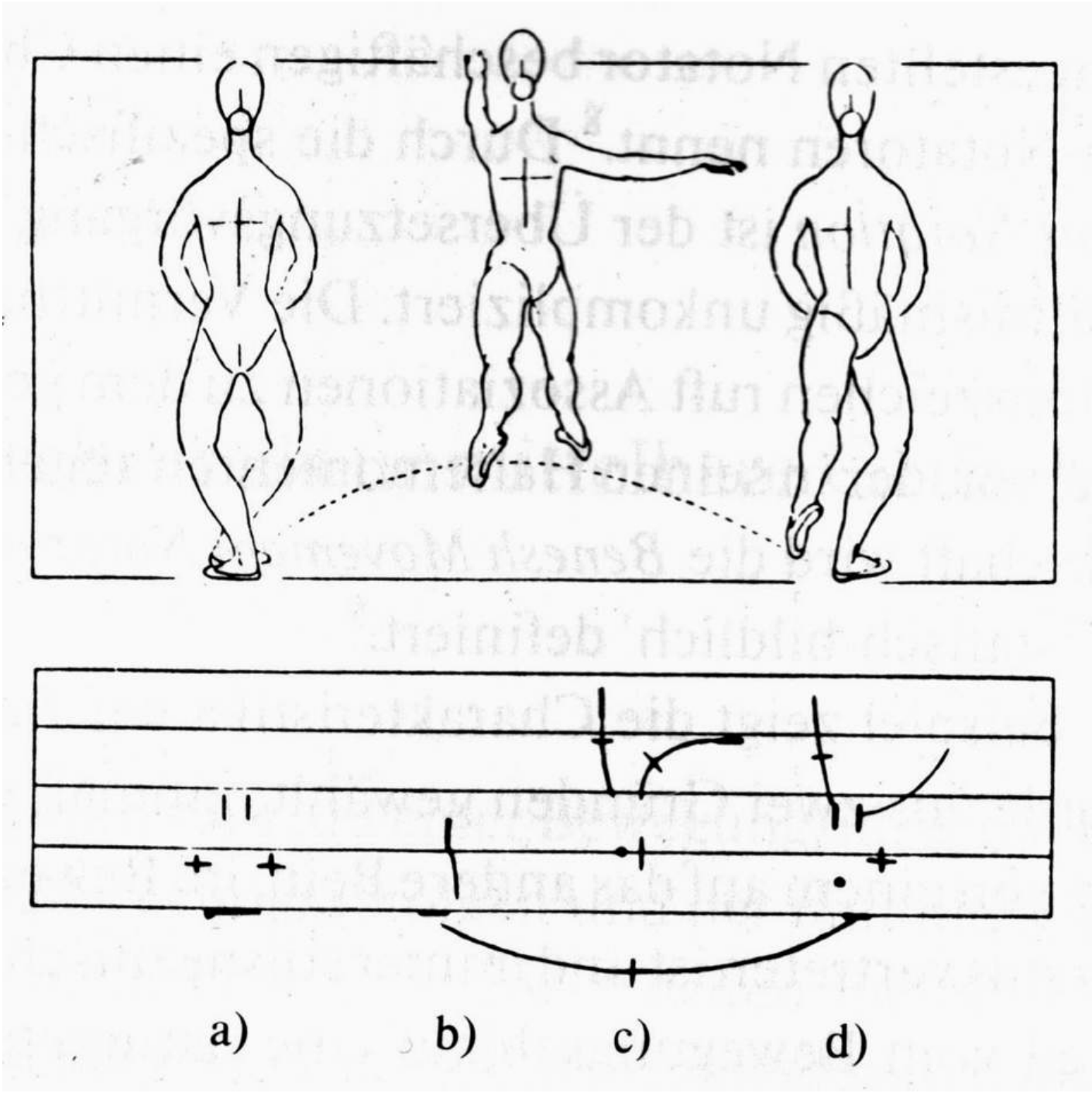
Kinetic Scripts: The Visual Language of Dance Notation
Source Type
↳ sourcetype.com/editorial/28285/kinetic-scripts-the-vis…
↳ *also see en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Dance_notation*



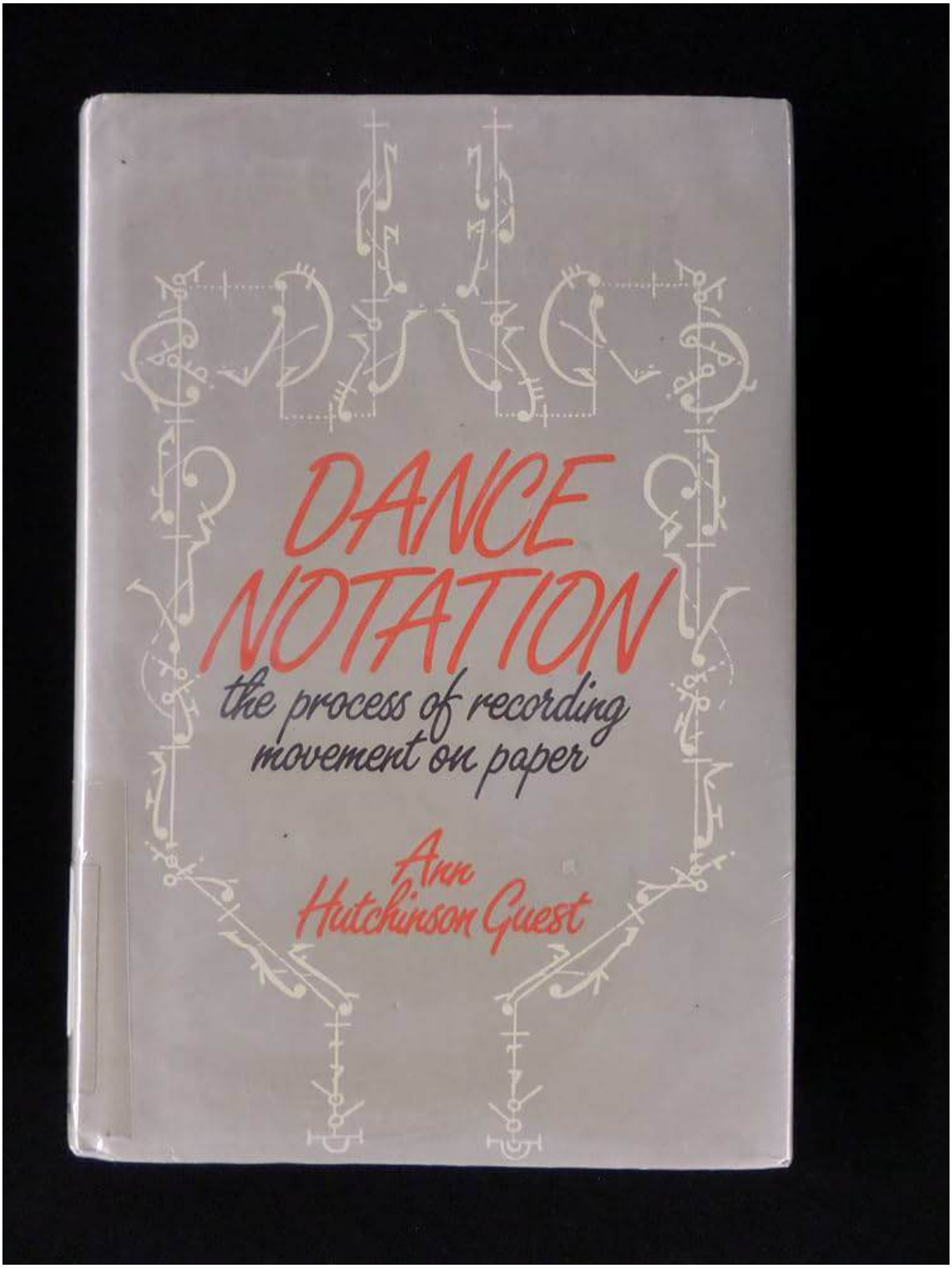
Chorégraphie ou l'art de décrire la danse
Raoul-Auger Feuillet (1700)
Baroque dance notation; the book that coined "choreography" as dance-writing.
↳ en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Beauchamp%E2%80%93Feuillet_notat…



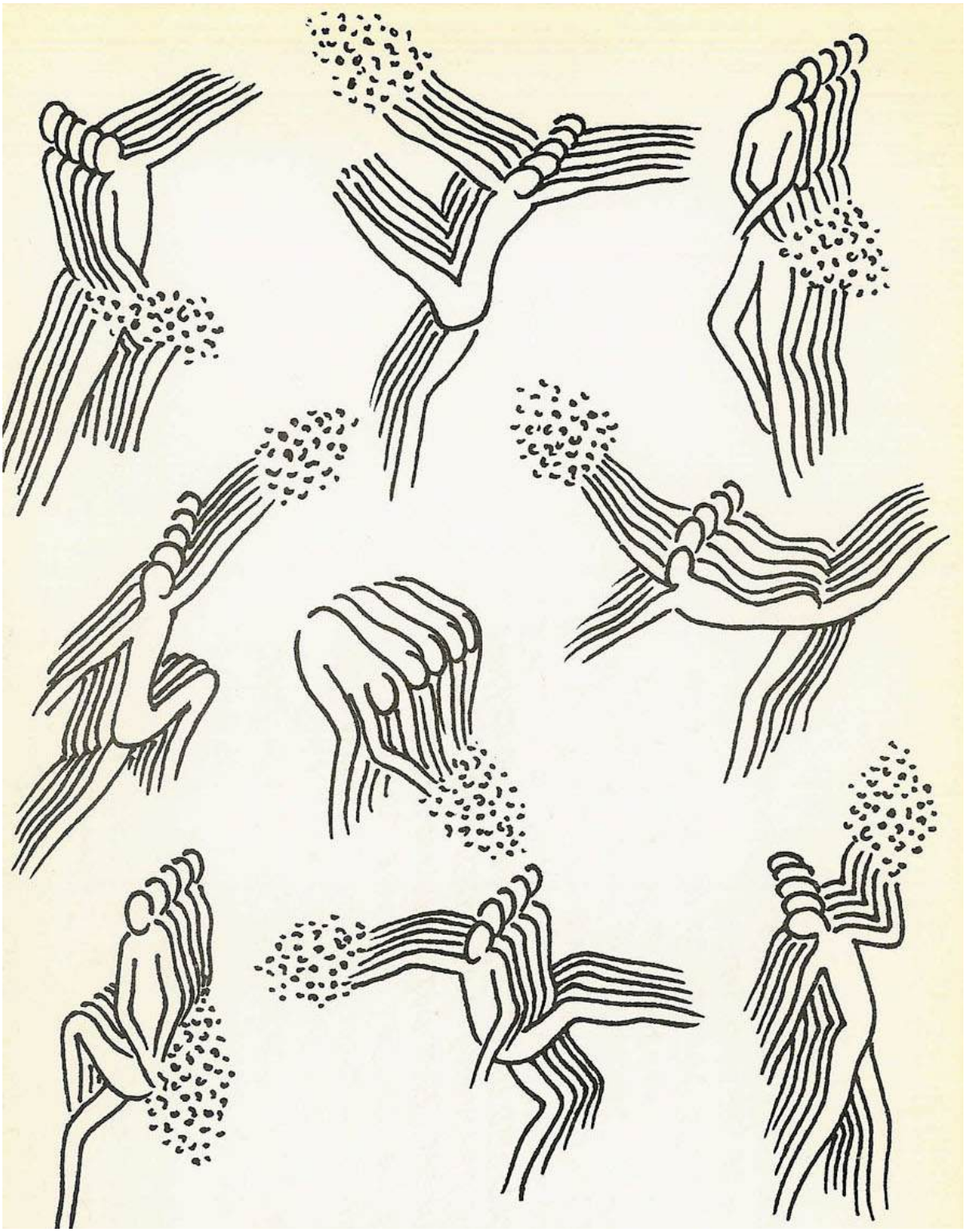
Benesh Movement Notation
Rudolf & Joan Benesh (1955)
Notation on a five-line stave seen from behind the dancer; standard in classical ballet.
↳ en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Benesh_Movement_Notation
↳ Video youtube.com/watch?v=eATNT4YA88I



Tanzschriften – ihre Geschichte und Methode
Claudia Jeschke (1983)
Illustrated history of dance notation from its beginnings to the present. Bad Reichenhall: Comes.
↳ SuUB Bremen suche.suub.uni-bremen.de/peid=B18358921&L…



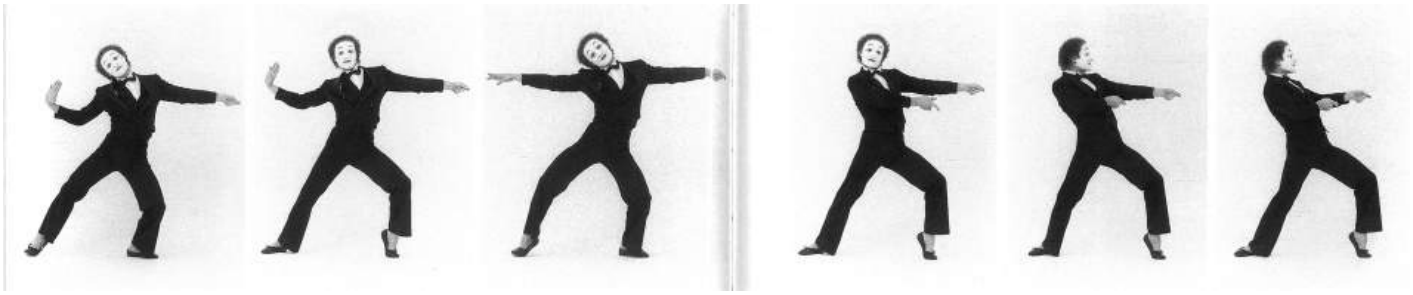
Dance Notation: The Process of Recording Movement on Paper (1984) / **Choreographics: A Comparison of Dance Notation Systems** (1989)
Ann Hutchinson Guest
↳ Choreographics (archive.org) archive.org/details/chor…



How to Write a Dance
Anna Heyward, *The Paris Review* (2015)
↳ theparisreview.org/blog/2015/02/04/how-to-write-a-dance



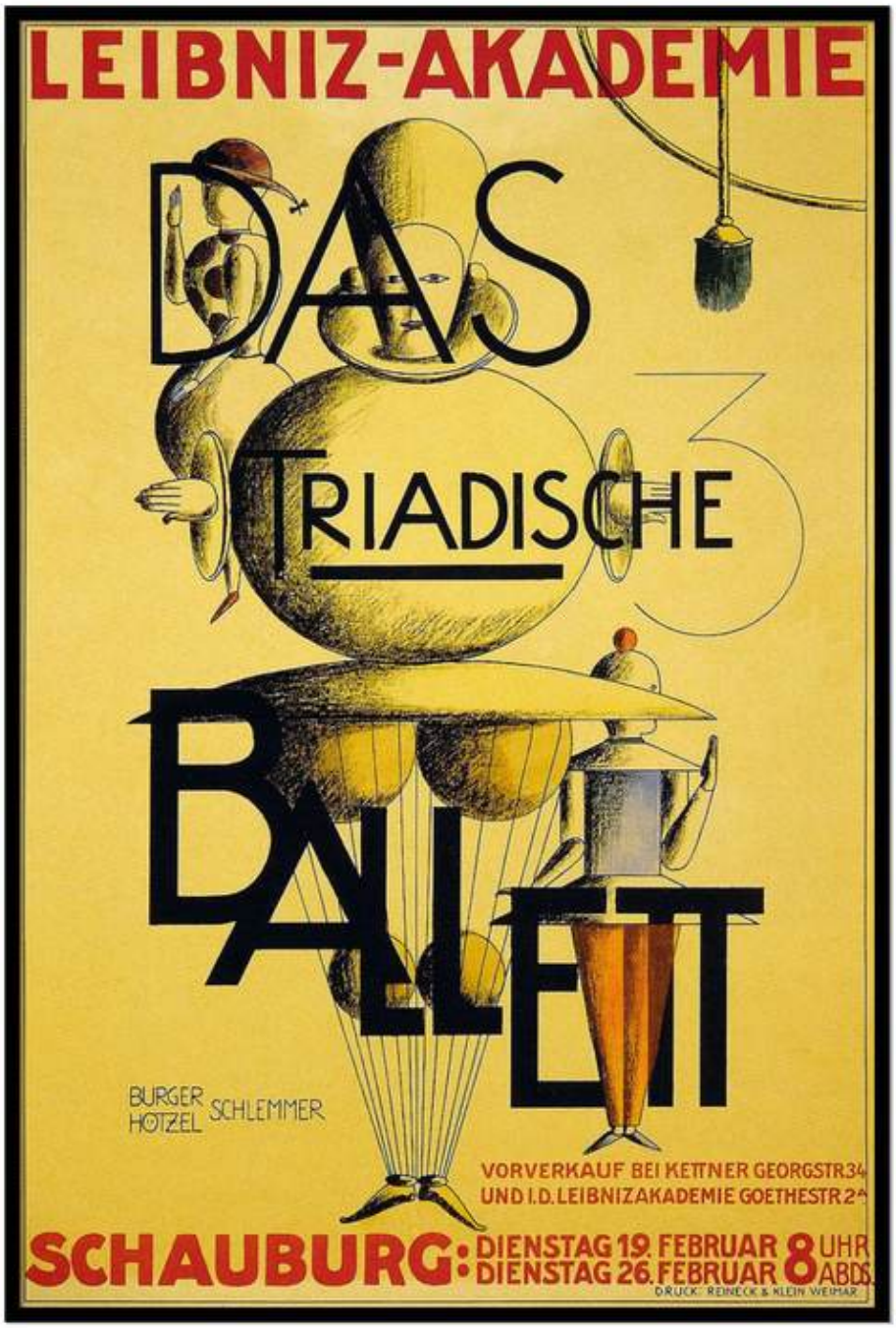
Chronophotography
Étienne-Jules Marey, Eadweard Muybridge (1870s–1890s)
Recording movement as an image and, in Marey's méthode graphique, *as a written trace.*
↳ en.wikipedia.org/wiki/%C3%89tienne-Jules_Marey
↳ en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Eadweard_Muybridge



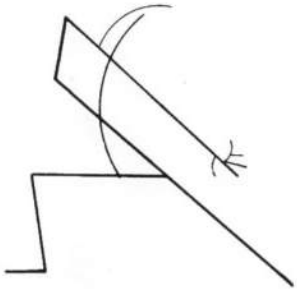
Movement Manuals
Illustrated technique books that break movement down into poses and sequences.

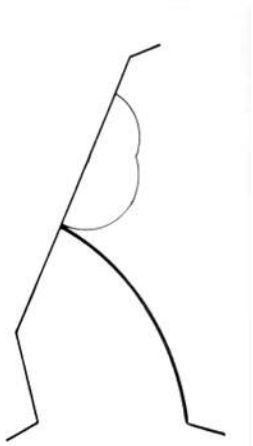
↳ Asaf Messerer, *Classes in Classical Ballet*. Transl. Oleg Briansky. New York: Doubleday 1975 / London: Dance Books 1976 – SuUB Bremen

↳ Yanci, *Movement and Gesture: The Illustrated Technics and Basics of Pantomime. A Guidebook*. Wilhelmshaven: Florian Noetzel (Heinrichshofen-Bücher) 1990 – SuUB Bremen



Triadisches Ballett (1922)
Oskar Schlemmer
Bauhaus performance exploring geometry, costume, and movement (premiered 1922).
↳ schlemmer.org/triadic-ballet
↳ en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Triadisches_Ballett



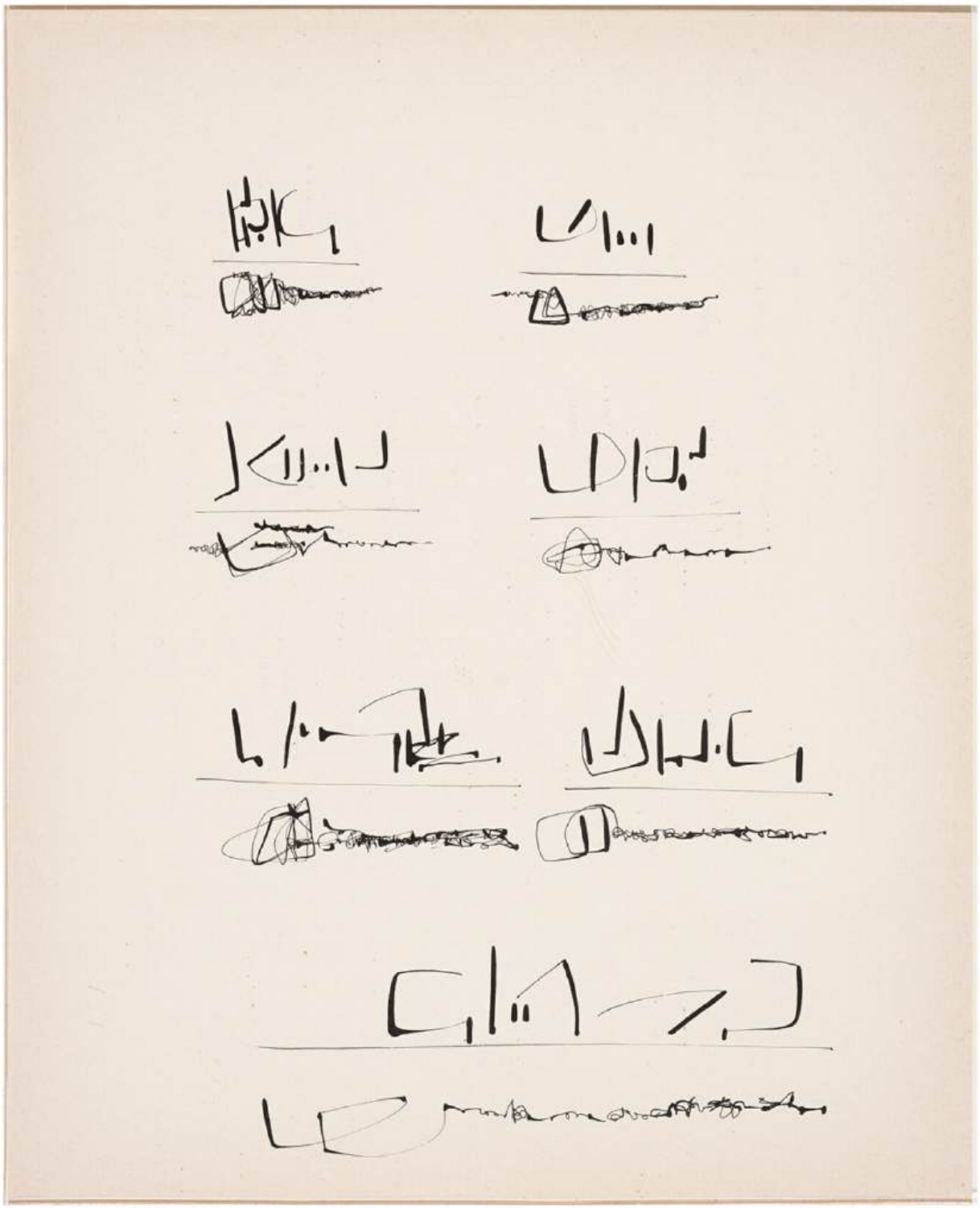




Kandinsky's Drawings of Dancer Palucca (1926)
↳ tanznetz.de/de/article/2023/palucca-und-kandinsky



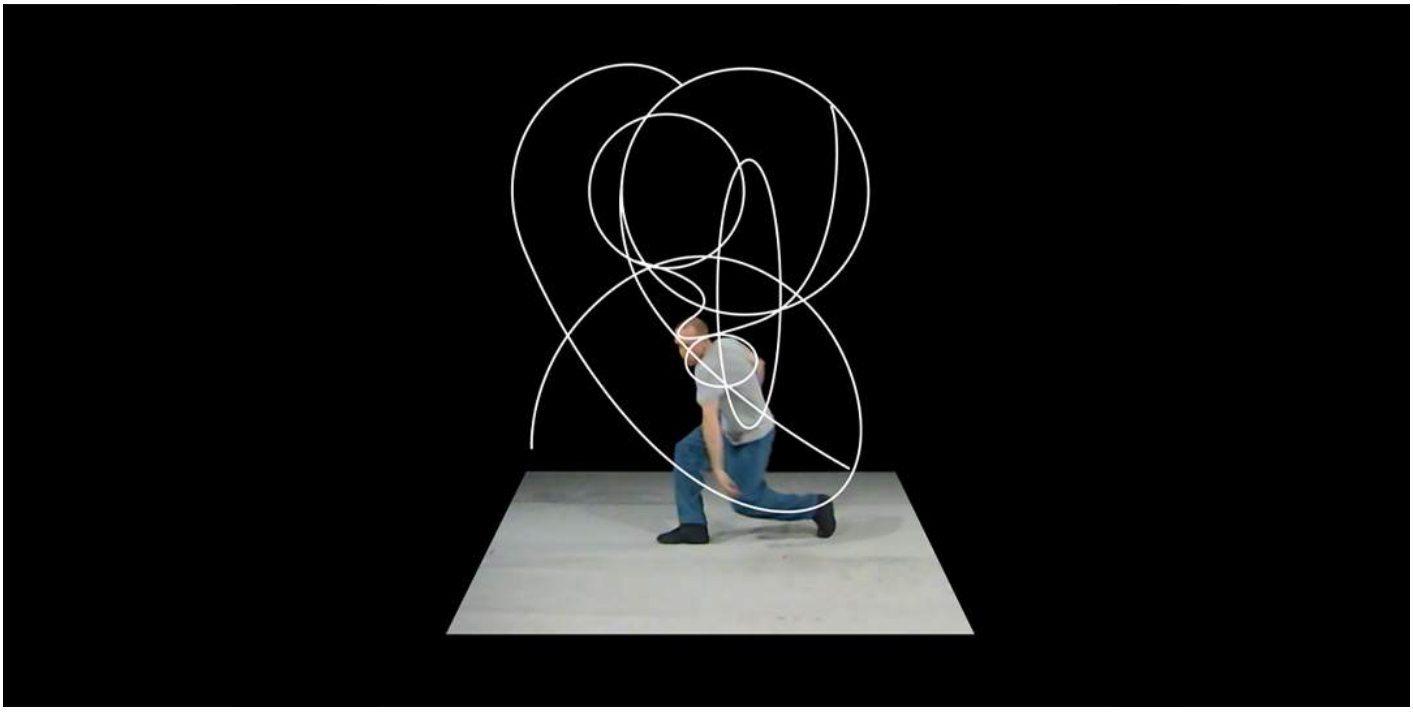
Bleistiftmaske (Pencil Mask)
Rebecca Horn (1972)
Body extension made of fabric straps and pencils; the wearer's head movements draw on the wall.
↳ artchive.com/?p=221030



Mirtha Dermisache
Diario Noº 1 Año 1 (1972)
Asemic writing: illegible scripts, letters and newspapers drawn in ink, writing reduced to the gesture of the hand.
↳ bombmagazine.org/articles/untitled-and-diario-no%C2%BA…



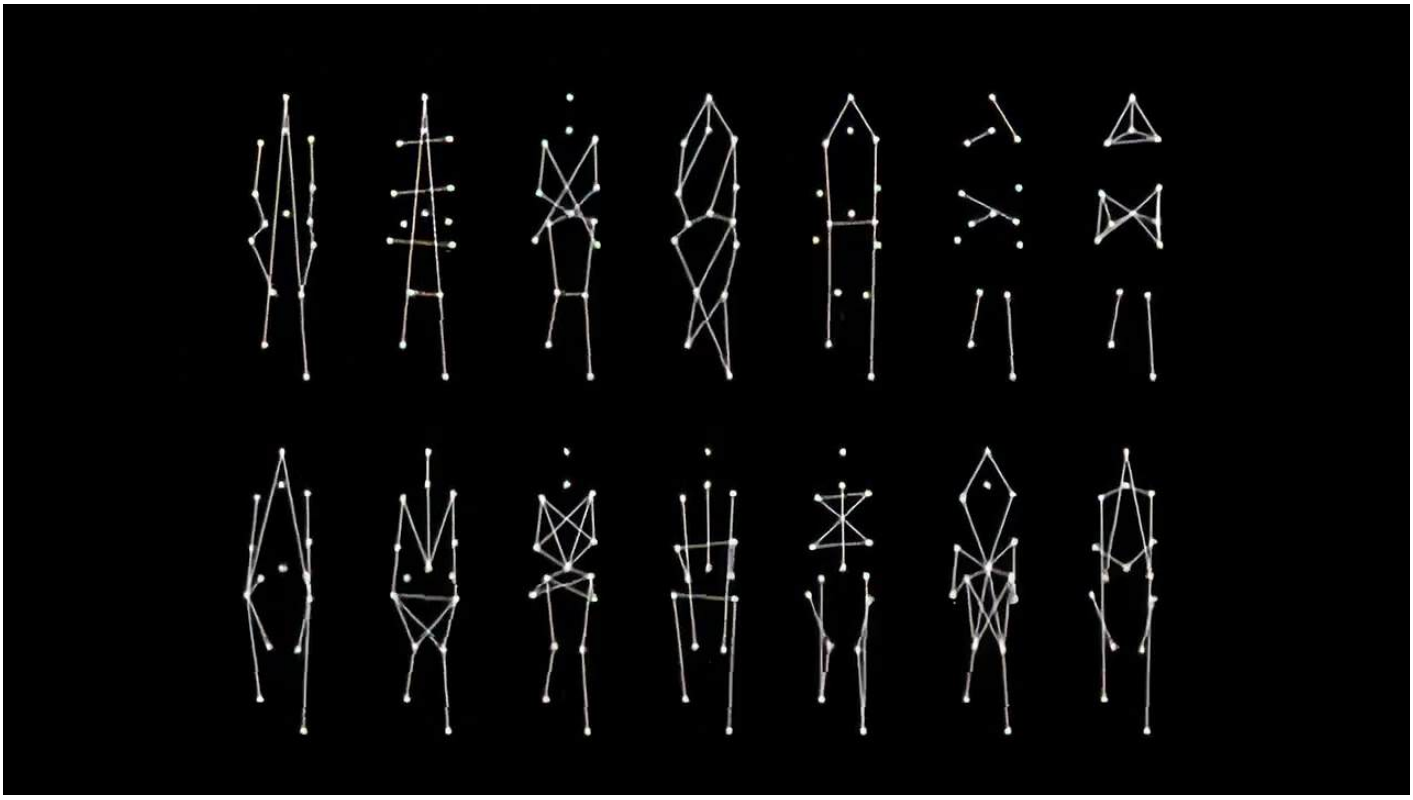
Trisha Brown
↳ Space Travel: Trisha Brown's Locus (1975) — Amanda Jan…
↳ It's a Draw (2002) trishabrowncompany.org/repertory/i…



Improvisation Technologies – Writing: Rotating Inscription
William Forsythe (ZKM, 1999)
↳ improvisation-technologies.zkm.de/lectures/writing



Cutie and the Boxer (2013)
Painting with boxing gloves
↳ passthepopcornreviews.wordpress.com/2014/07/17/cutie-a…



A-POC
Issey Miyake (1998)
Fashion design investigating movement through pleating and material.
↳ youtube.com/watch?v=sb6_COZyCEg



Trajal Harrell
Choreographer combining dance, fashion, and performance.
↳ betatrajal.org
↳ hebbel-am-ufer.de/en/programme/artist/adetail/trajal-h…



TED Talk
Wayne McGregor (2012)
↳ youtube.com/watch?v=KPPxXeoIzRY&t=576s
↳ Dancing the letter T youtu.be/KPPxXeoIzRY?t=258



Subterranean Homesick Blues
Bob Dylan (1965)
↳ youtube.com/watch?v=MGxjIBEZvx0



Poesie handverlesen
Project by deaf and hearing artists translating literature into German Sign Language and back.
↳ poesiehandverlesen.de
↳ poesiehandverlesen.de/screeningeintrag.php?p=103



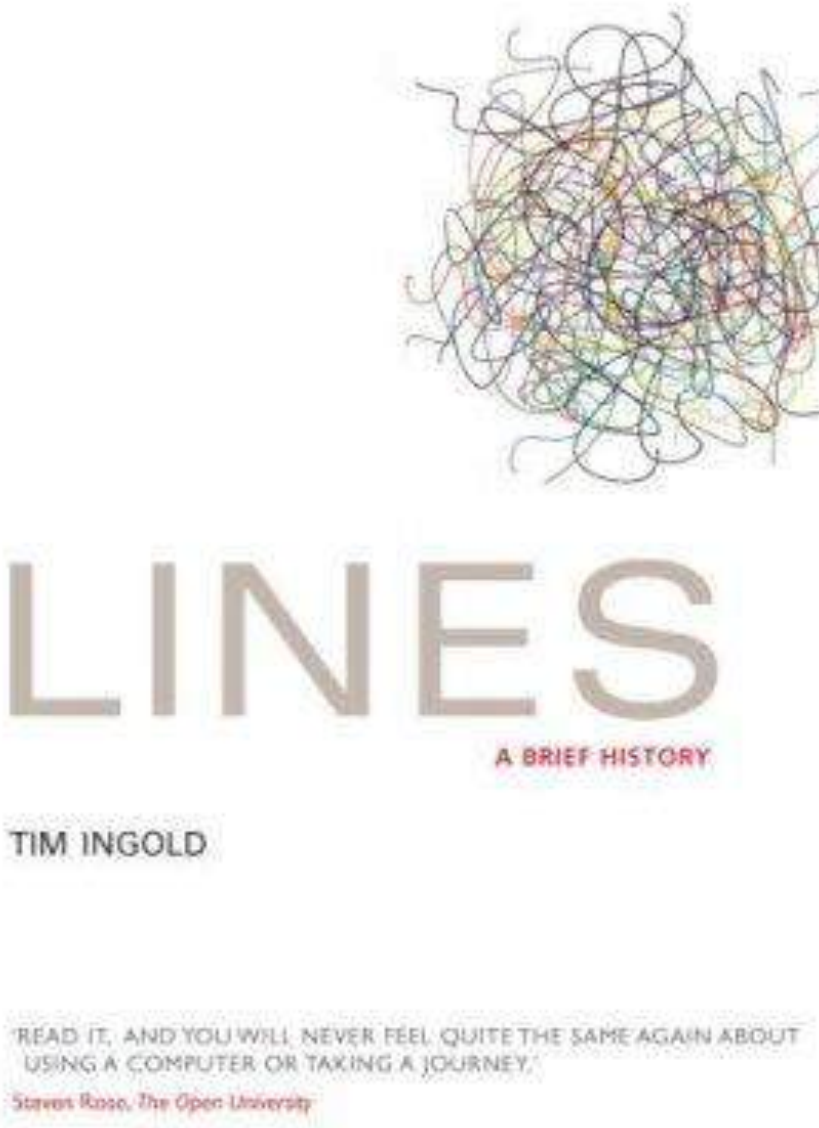
Nora Turato
Performance artist working with language: scripts from media, ads and conversations, recited from memory at high speed.
↳ instagram.com/reel/CbSzKUdDc_d
↳ kunsthallewien.at/en/event/nora-turato-pool7



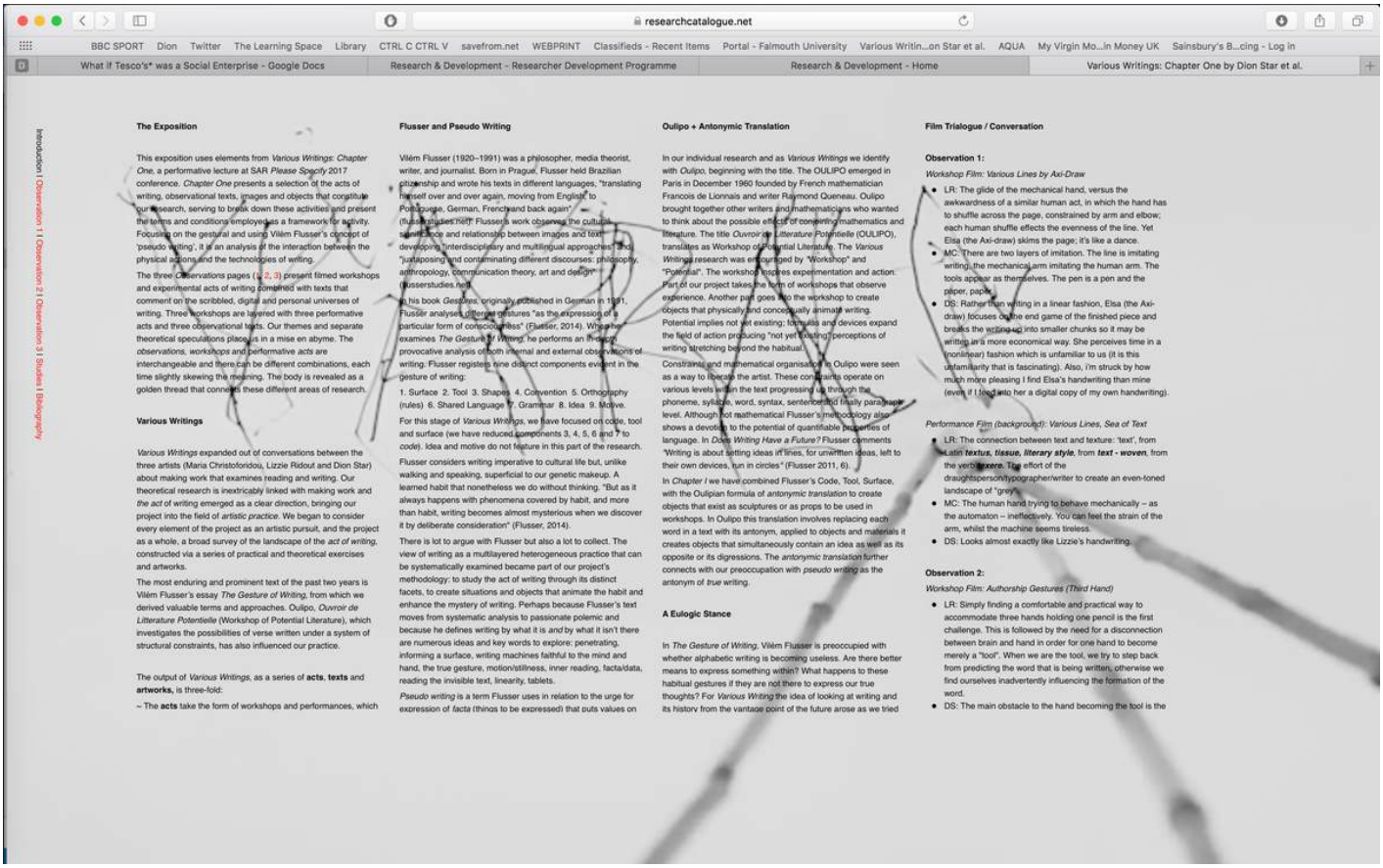
Punkt und Linie zu Fläche (Point and Line to Plane)
Wassily Kandinsky (1926)
Bauhaus book on the line as movement; includes the Palucca drawings (see 6.11).
↳ monoskop.org/images/1/11/Kandinsky_Punkt_und_Linie_zu_…



The Stroke: Theory of Writing (*De streek*)
Gerrit Noordzij (1985/2005)
Letterforms as traces of the moving hand: translation, expansion and rotation of the stroke.
↳ The Shape of the Stroke (RIDT 1991) typemedia.org/ass…

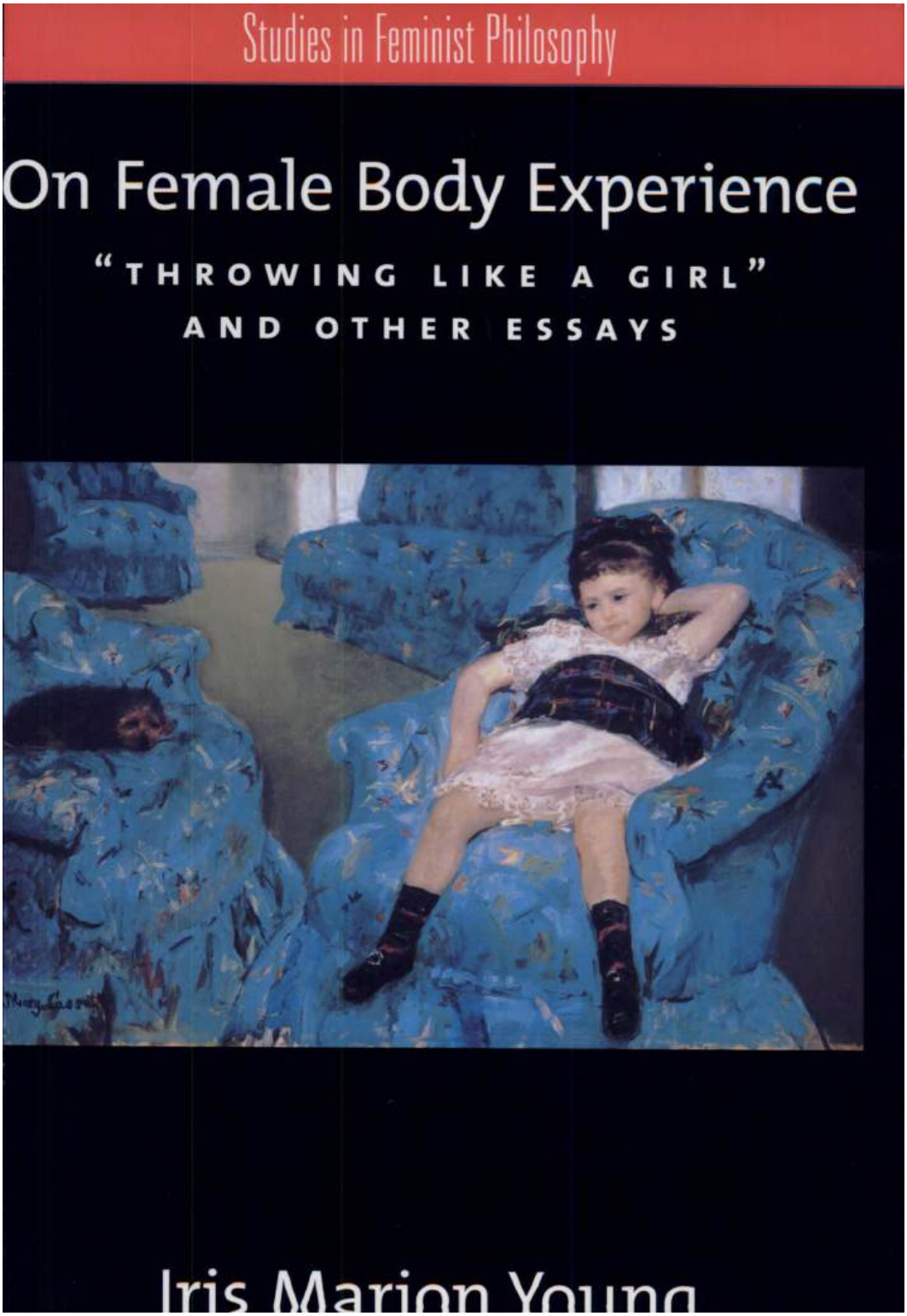


Lines: A Brief History
Tim Ingold (2007)
Walking, weaving, writing and notation understood as lines of movement.



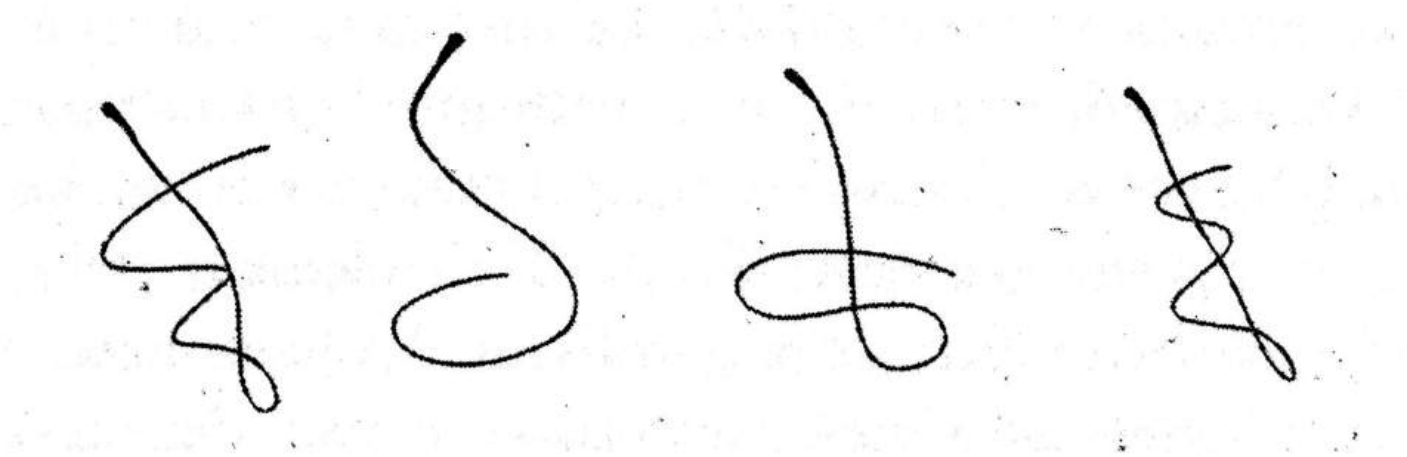
Gesten. Versuch einer Phänomenologie (1991) / **Die Schrift. Hat Schreiben Zukunft?** (1987)
Vilém Flusser
Writing as a gesture.
↳ flusserstudies.net/sites/www.flusserstudies.net/files/…
↳ Various Writings, Chapter One — Maria Christoforidou, …

Variations on Writing (*Variations sur l'écriture*)
Roland Barthes (1973)
Writing as a gesture of the hand: ductus, speed, pressure and rhythm of the stroke, before and beyond its meaning.
↳ Variationen über die Schrift (PDF, UZH) zora.uzh.ch/s…

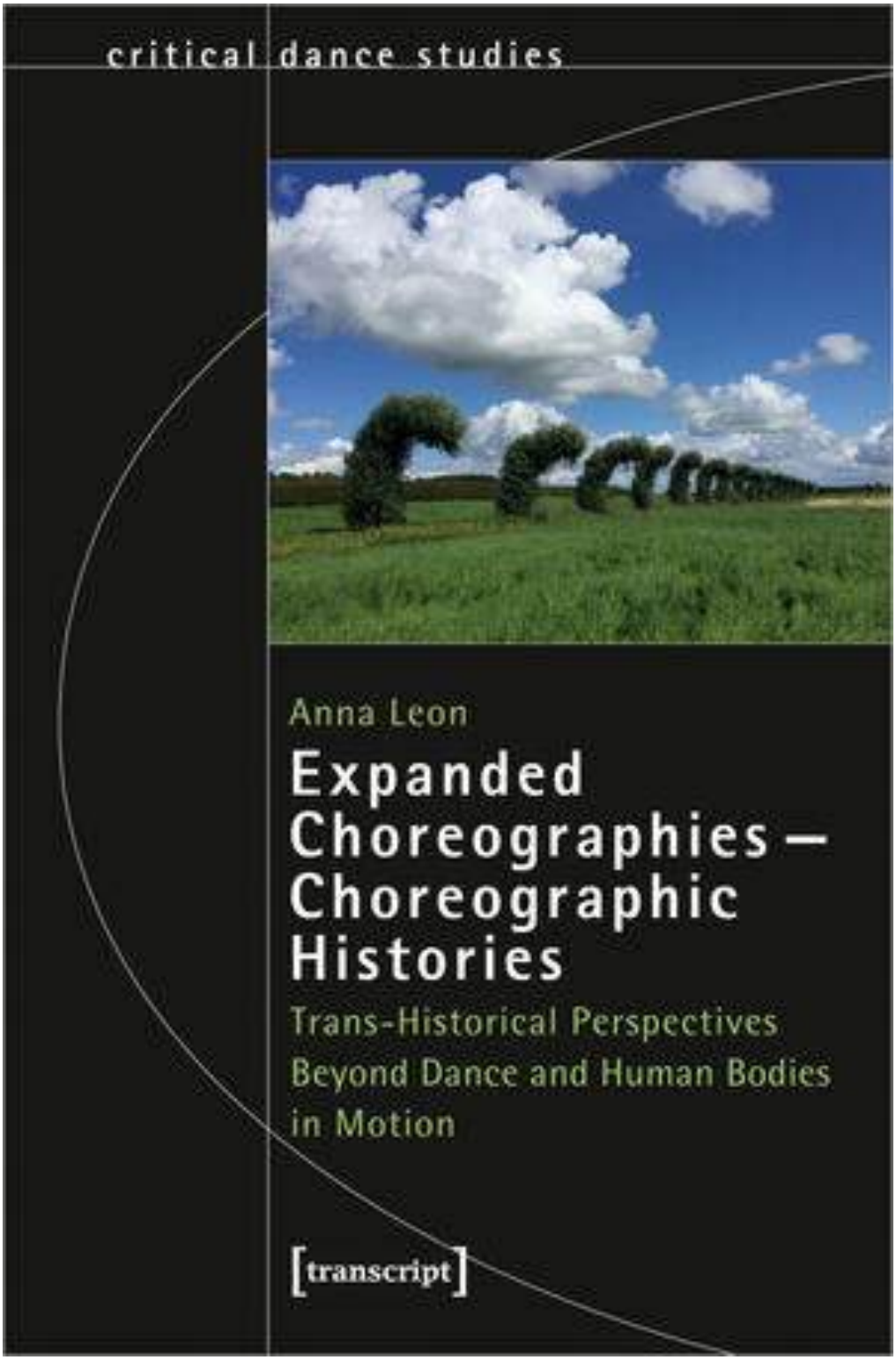

Studies in Feminist Philosophy
On Female Body Experience
"THROWING LIKE A GIRL"
AND OTHER ESSAYS
Iris Marion Young



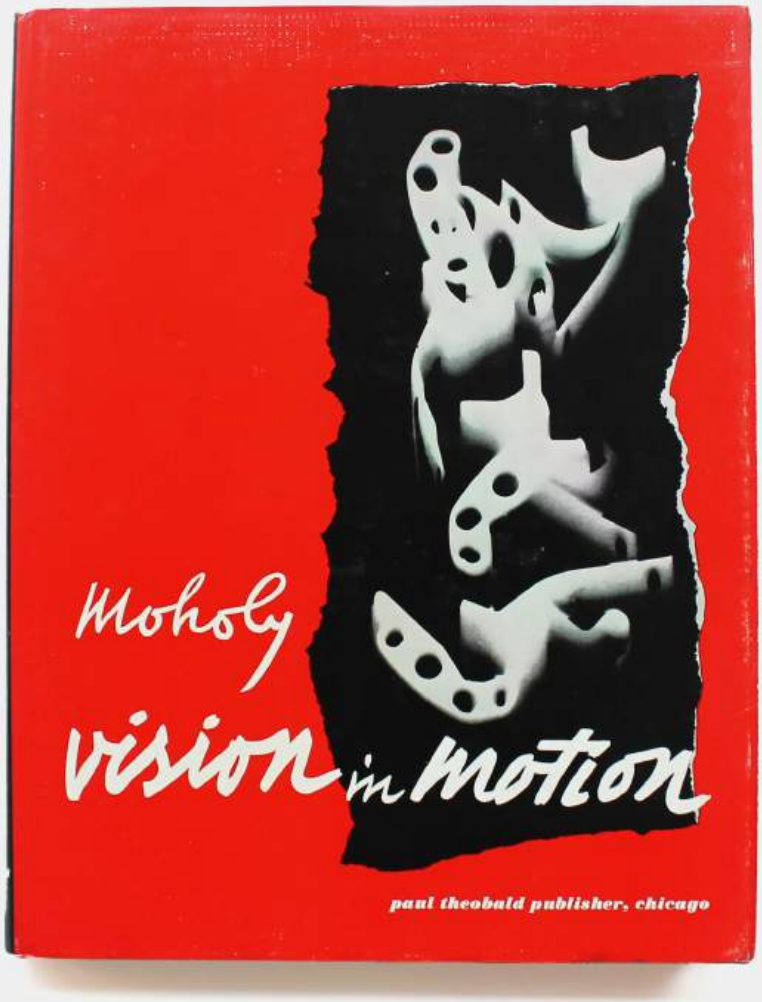
Choreographic Objects
William Forsythe (2008)
Short essay asking whether choreography can exist without the body (see 6.15).
↳ williamforsythe.com/essay.html



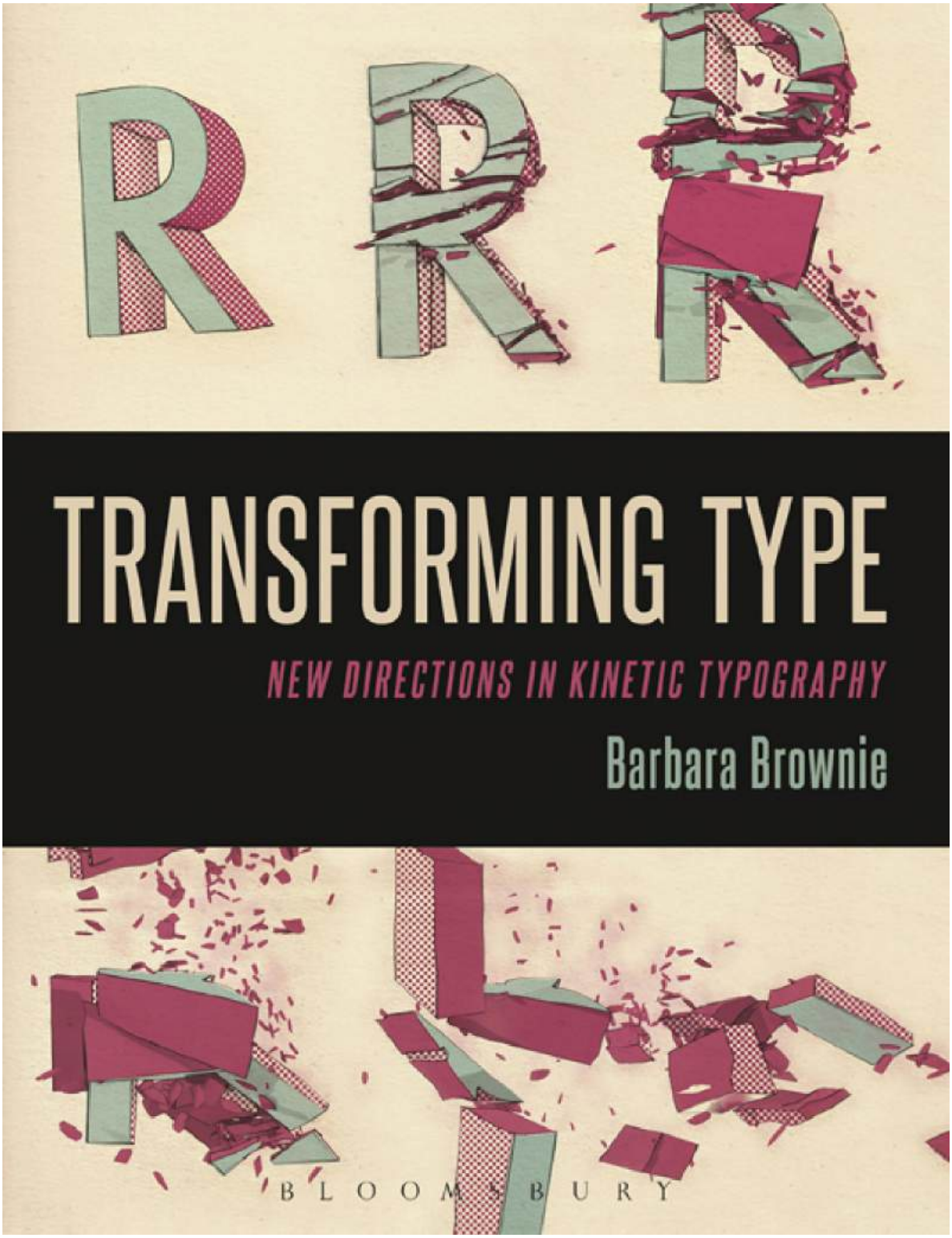
Notationen und choreographisches Denken (Notations and Choreographic Thinking)
Gabriele Brandstetter, Franck Hofmann, Kirsten Maar (eds.) (2010)
Essays on notation as a way of thinking and making choreography. Freiburg: Rombach.
↳ SuUB Bremen suche.suub.uni-bremen.de/peid=B62736521&L…



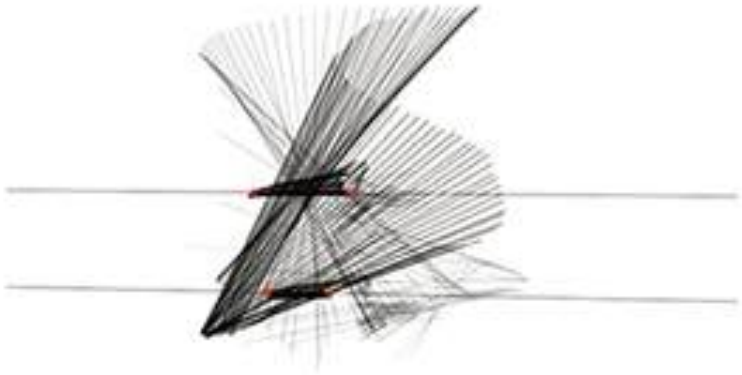
Expanded Choreographies – Choreographic Histories: Trans-Historical Perspectives Beyond Dance and Human Bodies in Motion
Anna Leon (2022)
Choreography understood beyond dance: how objects, spaces, texts and non-human bodies can be "choreographed", traced through history. Bielefeld: transcript (open access).
↳ PDF library.oapen.org/bitstream/id/84e603e8-0d78-498e…



Vision in Motion
László Moholy-Nagy (1947)
↳ monoskop.org/images/0/0d/Moholy-Nagy_Laszlo_Vision_in_…

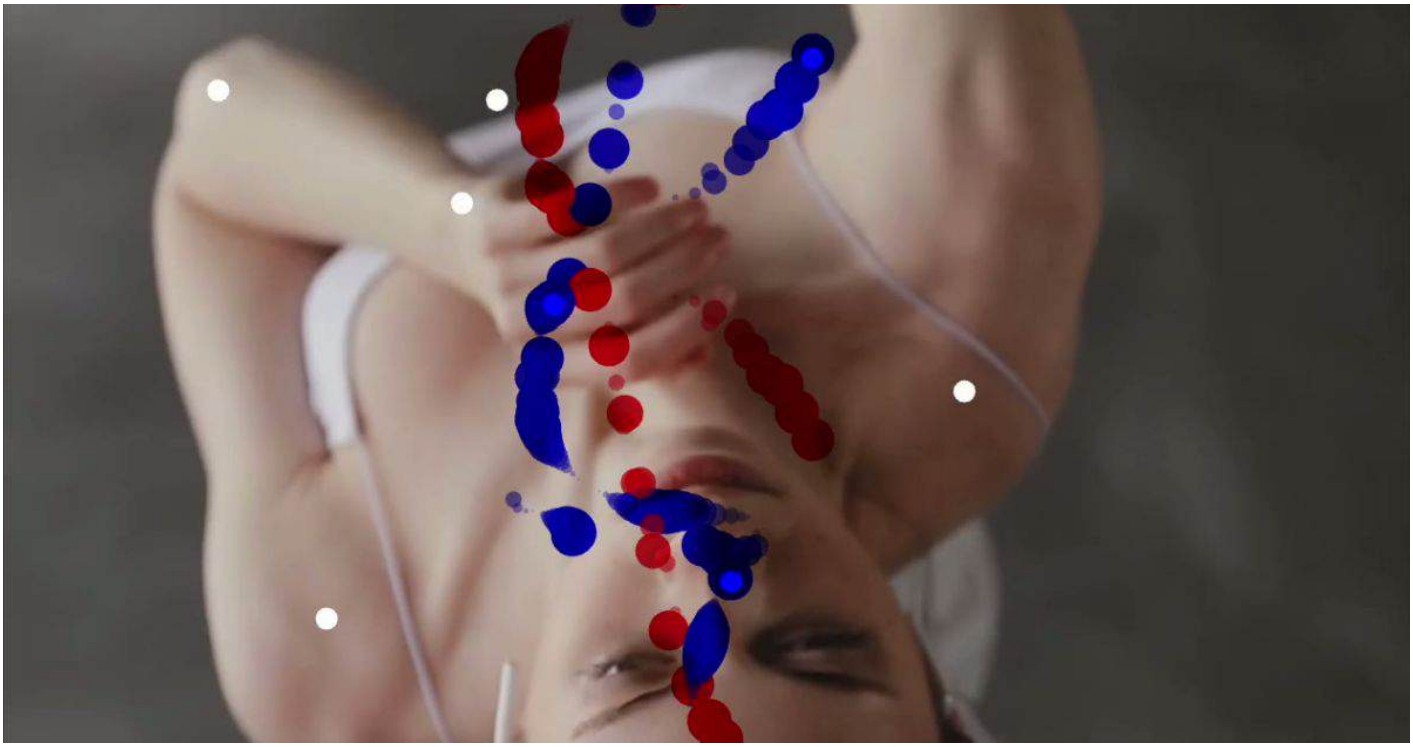


Transforming Type: New Directions in Kinetic Typography
Barbara Brownie (2015)
Academic study of kinetic and temporal typography.



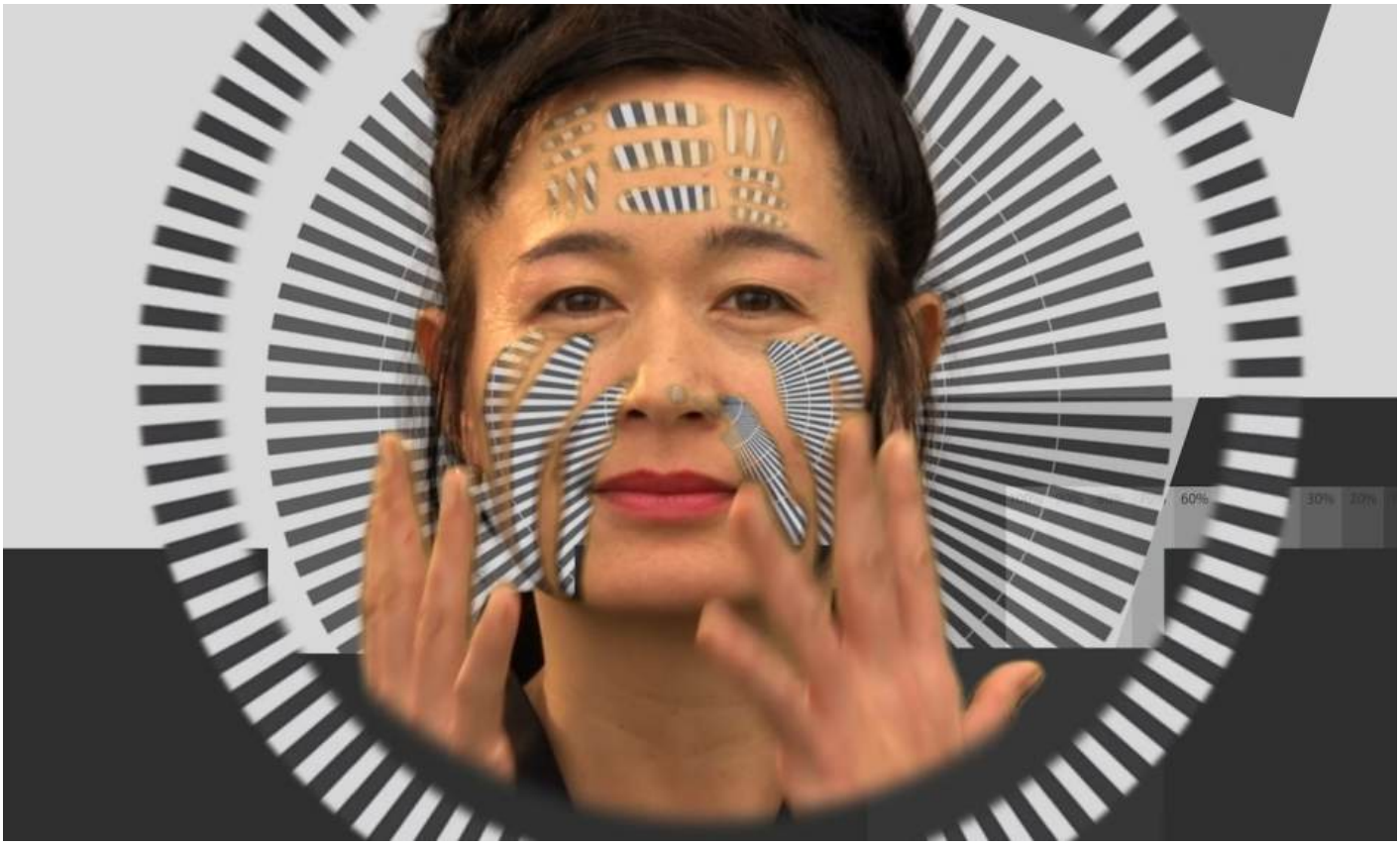


Materializing Movement / Designing for Movement-based Digital Interaction
Lise Amy Hansen and Andrew Morrison
Body-centered approach to interaction design and embodied cognition.
↳ ijdesign.org/index.php/IJDesign/article/view/1245/614

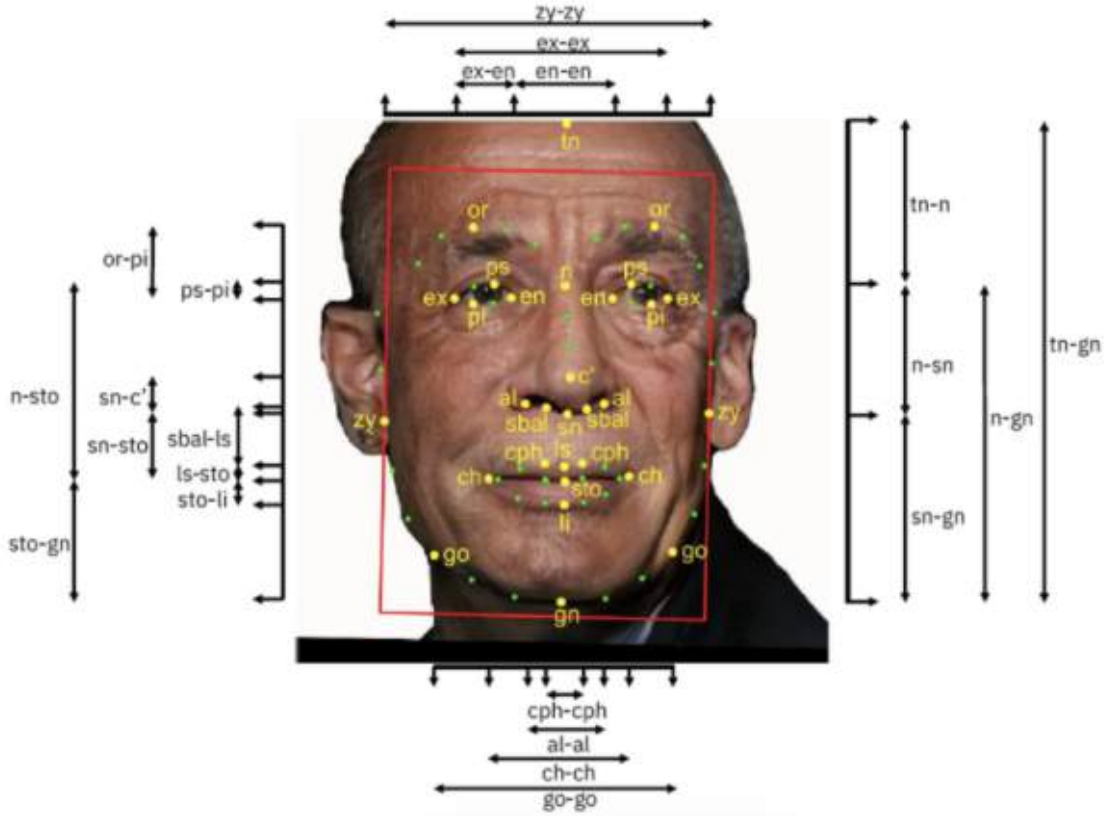




Archives of the Body
Hanne Loreck, Vanessa Gravenor (eds.), HFBK Hamburg
Research on the relationship between bodies and media in medicine, psychology, culture and politics.
↳ archives-of-the-body.hfbk.net



How Not to Be Seen: A Fucking Didactic Educational .MOV File
Hito Steyerl (2013)
Video tutorial on making the body invisible to cameras, satellites and recognition systems.
↳ moma.org/collection/works/181784



Excavating AI: The Politics of Images in Machine Learning Training Sets
Kate Crawford & Trevor Paglen (2019)
How training datasets classify human bodies; critical context for pose recognition.
↳ excavating.ai

Schriftkörper / Körperschrift (Type Body / Body Writing)
UdK Berlin
Seminar on typography, writing, and the body.
↳ udk-berlin.de/studium/studium-generale/lehrveranstaltu…

WS 26/27
HfK Bremen



Body, Space and Movement (Körper, Raum und Bewegung)
Burg Halle
↳ burg-halle.de/projekt/project/koerper-raum-bewegung-4



Medienhaus Lectures 2021
Talks on experimental typography and graphic design.
↳ slanted.de/medienhaus-lectures-2021